



CITY: Pg 3

Lakshmi arrives for Delhi women



NATION: Pg 5

'Change dil ka angle, not camera angle': Priyanka in barb against PM



FILM: Pg 12

High praise for Tom Holland; Sadie Sink's role pays off

Anti-paper leak Bill faces heat in LS

Govt terms anti-paper leak Bill affirmation of commitment; Opposition slams it for action on protesters

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: After a week of stalemate, a discussion on the anti-paper leak Bill began on Tuesday in Lok Sabha with the government describing it as a reaffirmation of its commitment to safeguard the welfare of students but Opposition hit back over the lathi charge on protesters, saying every blow on them hurt the government's prestige more than the backs of the youth.

Initiating the debate on the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, Union Minister of State for PMO Jitendra Singh said the Narendra Modi government finished an unaccomplished task to bring a law to prevent examination malpractices in 2024.

"Incidents of paper leaks have taken place in various states ruled by different parties... The anti-paper leak Bill

KEY PROVISIONS AND IMPLEMENTATION CHALLENGES



» **NO PENALTY FOR DELAYS:** Bill does not specify consequences if the two-month investigation deadline is missed, as seen in similar laws

» **FAST TRACK COURTS:** States/UTs must designate a Court of Session as a Special Fast Track Court, following the POCSCO model

» **BACKLOG PERSISTS:** As of April 2026, 775 Fast Track Special Courts, including 398 exclusive POCSCO courts, had more than two lakh pending cases

» **THREE-MONTH TRIAL DEADLINE:** Bill mandates completion of trial within three months of chargesheet, potentially conflicting with the Supreme Court's 2002 ruling against fixed deadlines for criminal trials

» **TWO-MONTH INVESTIGATION DEADLINE:** Bill requires investigations to be completed within two months, similar to timelines under the POCSCO Act and SC/ST Act.

» **IMPLEMENTATION CONCERNS:** Over 40% of cases under POCSCO and the SC/ST Act pending investigation in 2024 remained unresolved for more than six months

is a reaffirmation of the government's commitment to safeguard the welfare of students and youth. The amendment... (is being) brought to make the law more stringent," Singh said.

Singh introduced the Bill on Monday, days after student protests over the NEET fiasco led to Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation as education minister.

Attacking the government for the way it handled the students' protests, Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi said Prime Minister Narendra Modi needs to change his "dil ka angle"

instead of camera angles if he wants to win over Gen Z. Her sharp barb came over Modi's Instagram outreach to student protesters last week.

Continued on P4

NEET PROTESTS

SC orders release of protestors below 18 with no criminal record

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday restrained states from taking any coercive action against protesters in the recent student-led agitation and directed them to release those under 18 on the condition that none should have any criminal antecedents.

The apex court indicated that it might constitute an SIT headed by a former Supreme Court Judge for the investigation.

Hearing a batch of petitions alleging police brutality during demonstrations against irregularities in exams and the NEET paper leak, a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said a fair and independent probe on the matter was required.

"All states are hereby instructed to release children under the age of 18, who have been reported to be arrested



KEY POINTS

- » Minors may be freed on simple family or personal bonds
- » Top court signals possible SIT headed by former SC judge
- » Bench seeks fair, independent probe into protest violence allegations
- » Court says those responsible for excesses must face action

or detained in connection with the ongoing protests and who do not possess any criminal antecedents," the bench directed.

It said if necessary, these children shall be released upon the execution of a simple bond by themselves or their family members, especially if such a requirement is insisted upon for surety.

During the hearing, the bench also comprising Jus-

tices Joymala Bagchi and V Mohana observed, "Whosoever committed excesses, took law into their hands should be taken to task."

The bench took note of allegations such as the use of pellet guns, lathis embedded with nails, rubber bullets and electric batons on protesters resulting in severe life threatening injuries to several students and young women.

Continued on P4

NEET protest: SC to hear pleas on pellet firing, food volunteer detention

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to hear pleas filed by a former IPS officer and two persons, who claimed to have been injured by pellet guns fired during the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP)-led stu-

dents' protest at Jantar Mantar on NEET paper leaks. The plea was mentioned before the bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, who said the court would take up the matter along with other petitions arising out of the protests on August 3. Continued on P4

'RAF fired multiple munitions, plastic pellets on police direction during protests at Jantar Mantar'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: At least a dozen personnel of the Rapid Action Force (RAF) were issued pellet guns on the morning of July 20 to deal with student protesters in Delhi, but the controversial weapons were withdrawn from July 23 after allegations that they were used against

demonstrators, officials familiar with the RAF's internal inquiry said on Monday.

Media reports said five people, Sheikh Irshad Mansuri, a 25-year-old private firm employee, Nootan Toppo, a 32-year-old woman from Gurugram, a 28-year-old reporter, Prashant Singh, a 25-year-old resident of Bihar,

and 19-year-old Sahil Lochab, a student preparing for police recruitment, alleged they were hit by pellets during the July 20 protests.

The RAF is a specialised unit of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) deployed to handle riots and other public disturbances.

The internal inquiry also

quoted a CRPF inspector, who led an RAF team in the Outer Circle of Connaught Place near Palika Bazar on July 20, as saying he did not order personnel to fire pellet guns, the officials said.

"It is possible that more than one officer fired the pellet gun that afternoon. The personnel in the Continued on P4

CJP seeks govt clarity on FIR assurance after SC order

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Tuesday raised concerns over the Supreme Court's interim order directing the release of student protesters without criminal antecedents, alleging that a direction allowing continuation of investigations in existing

FIRs could be misused to target participants of the NEET protest movement.

Reacting to the order passed by a three-judge bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, CJP national spokesperson Saurav Das said Direction No. 4, which permits authorities to proceed with existing FIRs Continued on P4

Quick News

CENTRE SUMMONS META AFTER PM MODI'S POST REMOVED

NEW DELHI: The Centre has summoned Meta's global head of public policy after the social media company removed Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Facebook post in which he addressed India's youth and announced plans for stricter action against paper leaks, sources said on Tuesday. According to sources, Meta informed the government that the post was removed because of a glitch in its automated content filtering system. However, the explanation has not satisfied the government. Sources said the issue is "not settled and done" and that if an automated error led to the removal, Meta must improve its systems. The IT Ministry has called the company's global public policy chief for discussions. The post, originally shared by Modi on Instagram on July 23 and later posted on Facebook, featured his

Continued on P4

MAGNITUDE 7.1 EARTHQUAKE SHAKES PART OF JAPAN

TOKYO: A powerful earthquake measuring 7.1, later revised to 6.8 by the USGS, struck Japan's Kyushu on Tuesday, injuring about 40 people and damaging buildings. A mall floor collapsed, trapping people. Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi said rescue efforts were underway, while tsunami warnings were later withdrawn and transport suspended.

See P8

WINS INDIA'S FIRST PARA ATHLETICS GOLD

Sharmila scripts CWG history

MPOST BUREAU

GLASGOW: India celebrated a memorable day at the Commonwealth Games as Sharmila Dhankar became the country's first ever para-athletics gold medalist, while high jumper Sarvesh Kushare and weightlifter Valluri Ajaya Babu added two silver medals to the tally.

Sharmila created history by winning the women's F57 shot put title with a season's best throw of 9.81m late on Monday. Her victory also ended India's 20-year wait for a para-athletics medal at the Games. The previous medal came in 2006 when Ranjith Kumar Jayaseelan claimed bronze in the men's seated discus throw. The F57 category is meant for athletes with lower limb impairments, limb deficiencies or reduced muscle power.

Soon after, national record holder Kushare became the



TAKEAWAYS

» Sarvesh Kushare becomes first Indian to win Commonwealth Games high jump silver

» Valluri Ajaya Babu wins silver in men's 79kg weightlifting

first Indian to win a silver medal in the men's high jump at the Commonwealth Games. The 31-year-old cleared 2.25m and finished behind Jamai-

ca's Romaine Beckford, who secured gold on countback after both athletes failed to clear 2.28m. England's Jack Kimani claimed bronze with a jump of 2.20m.

Kushare bettered the bronze won by Tejaswin Shankar at the Birmingham Games four years ago, which had been India's only medal in the event. Tejaswin, who was also in the field on Monday, withdrew after failing to clear 2.05m in his opening attempt as a precaution before competing in the decathlon later this week. Adarsh Ram finished fifth with 2.15m.

Weightlifting remained India's strongest medal-winning discipline as 21-year-old Valluri Ajaya Babu secured silver in the men's 79kg category. The Andhra Pradesh lifter totalled 330kg with lifts of 149kg in snatch and 181kg in clean and jerk, finishing just one kilogram Continued on P4

Delhi reels under heavy rain, red alert issued



NEW DELHI: Heavy rain lashed Delhi on Tuesday, flooding roads, disrupting traffic and prompting the India Meteorological Department to issue a red alert for thunderstorms, lightning and intense rain. Water-logging was reported from Connaught Place, ITO, Kalindi Kunj and other areas, while Sadar Bazar saw waist-deep water. PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said Minto Bridge traffic remained smooth. Between 11.30 am and 2.30 pm, Pusa recorded the highest rainfall at 80 mm.

See P3

No more multiple official cars for bureaucrats

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Centre has tightened rules governing the use of official vehicles by introducing a "One Officer, One Official Car" policy that bars senior bureaucrats from being allotted multiple government vehicles even if they hold additional charge of another ministry, department, public sector undertaking

(PSU) or autonomous body.

The move is aimed at preventing misuse of official vehicles, avoiding duplication and ensuring prudent use of public resources.

In a recent Office Memorandum (OM), the Department of Expenditure under the Ministry of Finance directed all Union ministries and departments to strictly enforce the revised guidelines Continued on P4

India calls PoK polls a 'cosmetic exercise' as 14 protesters killed

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday dismissed the ongoing local body elections in Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir (PoK) as a "cosmetic electoral exercise", saying the voting was aimed at masking Pakistan's "illegal occupation" of the region and diverting attention from what it called serious human rights violations. The remarks came as the first phase of elections unfolded amid widespread unrest, with the banned Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC) alleging that at least 14 protesters were killed after Pakistani security forces opened fire on a long march near Rawalakot, a claim Continued on P4

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REFUSES TO REMOVE OFFICER FROM PROBE OVER PROTEST SLAPPING VIDEO

High Court: Cop’s image cannot be ‘tarnished’ due to ‘overuse of force’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Tuesday said the right to protest does not extend to damaging the “seat of sovereignty,” and a police officer’s image cannot be “tarnished” over an alleged “overuse of power” during the July 20 march to Parliament against the NEET paper leak.

Justice Girish Kathpalia made the observations while dismissing a petition seeking withdrawal of an inquiry from Delhi Police’s Additional DCP Sandeep Lamba, after he was seen slapping a woman during the ‘Chalo Sansad’ march called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and consequential administrative action was taken against him.

Advocate M Sufian Siddiqui contended that the petitioner’s confidence in the fairness of the inquiry into her alleged illegal detention in 2025 has been irretrievably shaken due to Lamba’s conduct, as seen in the video clip, and therefore, the proceedings should be assigned to an independent officer.

Justice Kathpalia, however, asserted that the police officer has the right to a fair trial, and



An injured protester during the ‘Chalo Sansad’ march, in New Delhi PFI

even if he is seen slapping a woman, he may not be biased in every case. “Just because he is caught on some video clip slapping a lady, we cannot tarnish him in black. Are we aware of the ground realities? How the crowd would have entered the Parliament and firing would have started. So many people would have died,” the court remarked.

“Fundamental right to protest is there, but it does not extend to damage the seat of sovereignty. You were approaching sovereignty. In

such a situation, how he has tackled the crowd, even if it is a case of overuse of power, that can’t be (used) to tarnish him like this,” it added.

Even as Siddiqui maintained that the petitioner was not tarnishing the police officer’s image, the court asked, “If I transfer the inquiry on this ground that in some other incident he is seen slapping somebody, is it not tarnishing? I am holding him guilty without hearing.”

The counsel for the authorities said nothing survived in

HIGHLIGHTS

» Justice Girish Kathpalia dismissed a plea seeking removal of Additional DCP Sandeep Lamba from an inquiry into an illegal detention case

» Plea argued Lamba’s appearance in a video showing him slapping a woman during the CJP’s ‘Chalo Sansad’ march had affected the petitioner’s confidence in the inquiry’s fairness

elderly woman who has alleged police excesses cannot be expected to ignore the subsequent supervening events concerning Lamba’s conduct as they affect her confidence in the authority responsible for investigating her complaint.

“During the pendency of the inquiry, Respondent No 2/Shri Sandeep Lamba-Addl DCP was shown in widely circulated video footage, extensively reported in the media, allegedly slapping a woman in broad daylight while in uniform, whereafter consequential administrative action was admittedly taken against him. The issue is whether, after such supervening developments, the petitioner can reasonably be expected to continue participating in the inquiry with the same confidence in the inquiry officer. The petitioner’s respectful answer is in the negative,” stated the petition.

The plea argued that since justice must not only be done but also be seen to be done, the principles of justice, fairness, and institutional integrity warrant that the inquiry be withdrawn from Lamba and handed over to an independent officer.

Police: 989 at CJP protest site had criminal records

Screened 2,873 people present at and around protest venue: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Scrutiny of 2,873 people present at and around the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest at the Jantar Mantar here has revealed that over 980 of them have previous criminal records, including cases of murder, attempt to murder, robbery, rape, kidnapping, crimes against women, illegal firearms and narcotics, according to official sources.

Police analysis showed that at least 101 people have been previously involved in murder cases, 62 in attempt-to-murder cases, 284 in robbery and dacoity cases, 229 under the Arms Act, 135 in snatching cases, 19 in kidnapping cases, and 67 in cases registered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, a senior police official privy to the probe stated.

They further said 61 of these individuals have been involved in rape cases, 25 in cases related to outraging modesty of women or molestation, while six have been booked



ried out through police databases and dossier verification systems, the source said.

According to police, criminal antecedents of 2,873 individuals were examined. Of them, 989 were found to have previous involvement in serious criminal cases, indicating that more than one-third of those screened had police records.

Police maintained that the exercise relied on existing criminal databases and dossier records kept by different district police units and other law enforcement agencies.

“The analysis showed that among the 101 people linked to murder cases, 42 have been involved in two or more criminal cases, while 12 have criminal histories involving 10 or more cases, suggesting repeated involvement in serious offences,” the source said.

Similarly, of the 62 people linked to attempt-to-murder cases, 25 have two or more criminal cases against them, they said.

Police records showed that 284 individuals have previously figured in robbery and dacoity cases. Police scrutiny of 2,873 people at the CJP protest found 989 with criminal records, including 229 linked to Arms Act cases, 67 to narcotics offences and 61 to rape cases. A total of 216 dossiers were processed.

Mule account syndicate with Dubai, UK links busted

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A cyber fraud complaint involving just Rs 10,000 has led Delhi Police to unravel a nationwide mule account syndicate that allegedly routed cybercrime proceeds to the tune of Rs 70 crore through 248 corporate bank accounts opened using shell firms and fake business entities, an official said on Tuesday.

Police said the investigation led to the arrest of six persons, including a bank manager, while four other bank officials and associates were apprehended or bound down for allegedly facilitating the racket.

“The syndicate had been supplying fully operational corporate current bank account kits to cyber frauds across India as well as operators based in Dubai and the United Kingdom for the past three to four years,” Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said in a statement.

The officer said the accounts were used to receive and layer proceeds of cyber frauds before the money was transferred to other accounts, making it difficult for agencies to trace the beneficiaries.

The six arrestees have been identified as alleged mastermind Dishant Khanna (36), bank manager Kundan Kumar (35), mule recruiters Mohit Soni (26) and Yogesh Kumar (35), shell firm owner Ranjeet Damion Ekka (41), and syndicate associate Mridul (22).

Police busted a cyber fraud account syndicate, arresting key accused and seizing 248 bank account kits. The network allegedly routed over Rs 70 crore through accounts linked to 156 NCRP complaints across 19 states.

Police register two FIRs over CCTV damage at CJP protest

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have registered two additional FIRs at the Parliament Street Police Station over the alleged theft and vandalism of CCTV cameras during the recent Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protests, taking the action separately from the 20 FIRs already lodged in connection with law and order violations.

According to police, the fresh cases were registered after examining evidence, including videos purportedly showing protesters damaging and removing CCTV cameras installed in and around the protest site.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma said the offences relating to the CCTV cameras would be investigated independently and would not be clubbed with the existing FIRs linked to the protests.

“Based on the evidence, we have registered two FIRs. These are not related to the FIRs already registered in connection with the protests. They cannot be clubbed together, as these concern the theft and vandalism of CCTV cameras,” Sharma said.



‘These aren’t related to FIRs already filed in connection with the protests,’ Sharma said

eras,” Sharma said. Police said videos circulating on social media allegedly show individuals pulling cameras from their mounts and damaging them. In one video, an accused is purportedly seen carrying a stolen CCTV camera to his house while others remove another camera from its stand.

Sharma said investigators were examining all available footage to identify those responsible. Besides the videos circulating online, police have also collected footage from nearby sources, including other CCTV cameras, which

TAKEAWAYS

» ‘We are collecting all available evidence, including videos recovered from various sources, to investigate the vandalism of the CCTV cameras and identify those responsible...’ he said

» Investigation is ongoing and action will be taken once the accused are identified, evidence has been examined: Police

will form part of the evidence. “We are collecting all available evidence, including videos recovered from various sources, to investigate the vandalism of the CCTV cameras and identify those responsible for damaging public property,” he said.

Police said the investigation is ongoing and action will be taken once the accused are identified and the evidence has been thoroughly examined. They added that those found responsible for damaging public property would face legal action.

Hepatitis burden a concern: AIIMS

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: AIIMS New Delhi marked World Hepatitis Day 2026 by highlighting the growing burden of viral hepatitis in India and emphasising the importance of awareness, early diagnosis and preventive healthcare.

This year’s observance was held under the theme, “Hepatitis: Let’s Break It Down”, focusing on addressing stigma, misinformation and barriers to the prevention, testing and treatment of hepatitis.

According to information shared by the institute, hepatitis is an inflammation of the liver caused by viral infections, alcohol, certain medicines and other factors. While hepatitis A and E generally result in acute infections, hepatitis B and C can progress to chronic liver disease, cirrhosis and liver cancer if left untreated. AIIMS noted that treatment for hepatitis C can cure more than 95 per cent of patients, whereas hepatitis B requires long-term antiviral therapy to control the infection.

The institute said India continues to bear one of the world’s highest burdens of viral hepatitis, accounting for nearly 12

Urged people to adopt healthier lifestyles by avoiding alcohol...

per cent of global cases. It estimates that around 40 million people in the country are living with chronic hepatitis B, while between 6 million and 12 million have hepatitis C.

AIIMS also drew attention to the growing burden of lifestyle-related liver disease, saying alcohol consumption and metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease (MASLD), previously known as non-alcoholic fatty liver disease (NAFLD), are emerging causes of cirrhosis and liver cancer. Citing recent studies, it said nearly 38 per cent of Indians, including around 35 per cent of children, are affected by fatty liver disease. The institute urged people to adopt healthier lifestyles by avoiding alcohol, maintaining a balanced diet, exercising regularly and undergoing timely screening where appropriate. WHO aims to eliminate viral hepatitis by 2030 through awareness, vaccination, early diagnosis and improved treatment access.

Experts highlight need to curb hepatitis stigma

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Prevention, early diagnosis and equitable access to treatment were the focus of the Illness to Wellness Foundation’s conference on “Prevention, Diagnosis and Treatment for Hepatitis”, organised on World Hepatitis Day 2026, as experts called for a stronger prevention-first approach to eliminate viral hepatitis by 2030.

Padma Bhushan Dr (Prof.) S. K. Sarin said India must prioritise expanding adult hepatitis B immunisation, promoting early diagnosis, eliminating stigma and ensuring timely treatment. “Preventing hepatitis is no longer only about scientific progress; it is about reaching every individual with the care they need,” he said.

Women’s health featured prominently in the discussions, with experts advocating universal hepatitis screening during pregnancy, measures to prevent mother-to-child transmission, timely birth-dose vaccination, improved maternal care and long-term monitoring of exposed infants.

Experts stressed that vaccinating newborns within the first hour of birth, or at least



within 12 hours, remains the single most effective intervention to prevent hepatitis B transmission. They said every pregnancy and every birth should be treated as an opportunity to prevent the disease.

Former Union Health Secretary Rajesh Bhushan called for stronger collaboration among governments, healthcare providers and other stakeholders to expand hepatitis services and ensure quality care reaches every community, particularly in rural areas.

Anil Rajput called for a “whole-of-society approach” involving all stakeholders to eliminate hepatitis. Dr R. S. Mishra stressed timely testing, reducing stigma and learning from countries such as China and Egypt to strengthen India’s hepatitis elimination efforts.

Police op targets ATM hotspots, mule accounts; 12 held

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Police of Delhi Police arrested 12 alleged cybercriminals during a 24-hour special operation targeting ATM hotspots where proceeds of cyber fraud were allegedly withdrawn.

According to police, six FIRs were registered during the operation, 68 suspected mule bank accounts were verified, and several electronic devices, banking documents and other incriminating material

were seized.

Police said the operation was launched after technical analysis indicated that cybercrime syndicates were using mule bank accounts to receive money defrauded from victims before withdrawing the funds from specific ATMs within the jurisdiction of the West District Cyber Police Station.

The mule accounts were found to be linked to more than 100 complaints lodged on the National Cyber Crime



Reporting Portal (NCRP), involving frauds worth several lakh rupees.

As part of the investigation, police examined 28 identified

ATMs and scrutinised footage from more than 100 CCTV cameras installed at these locations and other relevant sites. Investigators also analysed bank account details, call detail records, money trails and digital evidence to identify those involved and trace the flow of illicit funds.

The operation was carried out by teams from the West District Cyber Police Station under the guidance of Inspector Vikas Kumar Buldak, Station House Officer, and ACP

Vijay Singh, with overall supervision by senior district police officers.

Police conducted simultaneous raids based on investigation inputs and arrested suspects allegedly linked to mule accounts, cyber fraud call centres and money withdrawal networks. The recoveries included phones, SIM cards, computers, bank documents, cards and digital devices. Further investigation is underway to trace the money trail.

4 feared to have drowned in Yamuna; 2 bodies recovered

NEW DELHI: Two bodies have been recovered from the Yamuna in east Delhi’s Gandhi Nagar, where four people were feared drowned, officials said on Tuesday.

The search operation has been suspended due to adverse weather conditions, they said.

The incident was reported from near Madina Masjid on Zero Pusta Road on Monday evening. Police said they received a call about the inci-

The identities of the deceased, remaining missing persons are yet to be ascertained

dent at 7.20 pm on Monday and rushed a team to the spot.

The fire officials were also informed and two fire rescue teams were also rushed to the site. A search operation was launched immediately after the teams reached the spot.

Two bodies have been fished out so far, a fire official said.

The official said the rescue operation had to be halted due to bad weather conditions and will resume once weather permits. The identities of the deceased and the remaining missing persons are yet to be ascertained. The exact circumstances leading to the incident are also not immediately known. Further investigation is underway. MPOST

Narela: Illegal drug unit busted

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Drugs Control Department, along with the Food and Drug Administration (FDA), Haryana, and Delhi Police, has busted an alleged illegal drug manufacturing and stocking racket operating from a residential apartment in outer Delhi’s Narela, officials said on Tuesday.

The two-day operation was launched following intelligence inputs about the suspected movement of spurious

medicines from the premises. Officials said the raid uncovered an unlicensed manufacturing and packaging unit inside the apartment, where equipment including sealing machines, weighing scales, electric stirrers and drug packaging material were recovered.

The team seized thousands of unlabelled tablets suspected to be Tofacitinib, anabolic steroid injections, chemical solutions and other raw materials. Additional searches in common utility areas of the apartment complex led to the

recovery of steroid hormone powders, over 1,500 finished injection vials marked “Made in Germany”, loose tablets, empty vials, packaging material and documents allegedly linked to the operation. Officials said no drug licence, purchase records or stock registers were produced during the inspection. Samples of the seized material have been sent for laboratory analysis, while preliminary findings indicate violations under Sections 18, 18A and 18B of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940.

HEAVY SHOWERS SWAMP ROADS, FLOOD MARKETS AND CHOKE TRAFFIC; IMD ISSUES RED ALERT

RAIN PLAYS BOSS, DELHI OBEYS

CM reviews waterlogging situation, directs officials to strengthen drainage systems | NDMC resolves 38 rain-related complaints

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Heavy rain brought Delhi to a standstill on Tuesday, inundating roads and markets, triggering widespread traffic congestion and forcing schoolchildren to wade through waist-deep water in some areas. As the downpour continued through the day, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) issued a red alert for thunderstorms, lightning and intense spells of rain, while forecasting a generally cloudy sky with heavy showers for the rest of the day.

Waterlogging was reported from Connaught Place, Janpath, Bharat Mandapam Road, Barakhamba Road, Mathura Road near ITO, Kalindi Kunj and several roads in Lutyens' Delhi. Large pools of water formed at major intersections, slowing traffic and leaving commuters stranded on several arterial roads.

Traffic jams were reported on NH-8 near Shankar Vihar, Zakir Hussain Road, the Delhi Cantt-Naraina Flyover-Mayapuri stretch, ITO, Old Rohtak Road, the Madhuban Chowk-Netaji Subhash Place stretch, Peeragarhi, NH-48 near AIIMS, Delhi-Noida Road, Kalindi Kunj, Vikas Marg, besides routes connecting Greater Kailash-II, Savitri Cinema, Chirag Dilli, Hauz Khas, RK Puram, Sangam Vihar and Khanpur via MB Road.

One of the worst-hit locations was Sadar Bazar, where waist-deep water flooded narrow lanes. Schoolchildren, office-goers and shoppers were forced to wade through the water, while videos on social media showed some children being carried on their parents' shoulders. Rainwater entered several shops, disrupting busi-



Delhi grapples with flooded roads, traffic snarls and relentless rain on Tuesday

ness. The Sadar Bazar Traders' Association said the market remained waterlogged till evening, forcing many establishments to shut.

Rajendra Nagar, a major coaching hub, was also submerged, reviving memories of the 2024 basement flooding tragedy in which three civil services aspirants lost their lives. Several cars, motorcycles and auto-rickshaws were partially submerged.

Between 11.30 am and 2.30 pm, Pusa recorded the highest rainfall at 80 mm, followed

by Janakpuri (72 mm), Lodi Road (63.4 mm), Chhatarpur (57.5 mm), Safdarjung (51 mm), Ayanagar (50.1 mm), Naraina (44 mm), Ridge (37.3 mm), Mayur Vihar (33.5 mm), Palam (26 mm) and Jafarpur (8 mm), while Najafgarh received no rainfall during the period. Safdarjung recorded a minimum temperature of 25.5°C.

Amid the rain, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta travelled in a Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus to inspect waterlogging-prone areas in Rohini and nearby localities. Review-

ing drainage, road conditions and cleanliness, she directed officials to strengthen the drainage network and prioritise road repairs. "The roads of the capital are not merely a means of transport but are also an integral part of Delhi's identity," she said, adding that "development will be visible on the ground, not just in files," while stressing that providing Delhi with a "clean, safe, accessible and beautiful capital" remained the government's highest priority.

Public Works Department

Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh shared a video from Minto Bridge, saying, "Rain is pouring relentlessly, but life on Minto Bridge is moving along at the same pace. The very effort is to ensure that the monsoon remains just a season, not a trouble."

The rainfall also triggered a political exchange. AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj, sharing videos from Sadar Bazar, said, "Schoolchildren are being forced to pass through waist-deep rainwater," and accused the BJP government of



PTI

No better in Noida & Ghaziabad

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA/ GHAZIABAD: A moderate spell of rain on Tuesday afternoon brought traffic to a crawl across Noida and Ghaziabad, inundating key roads, stranding commuters and schoolchildren, and exposing persistent drainage failures in several parts of the twin cities.

Noida recorded 56 mm of rainfall by 5.30 pm, with severe waterlogging reported near Mahamaya flyover, Chilla, and sectors 19, 34, 37 and 100. In Sector 19 and Barola, children were seen wading through knee-deep sewage-mixed water after school. Traffic snarled near the Mahamaya flyover around 3 pm after a car got stranded in the flooded underpass between the furniture market and Sector 94. Commuters pushed the vehicle to the roadside to ease congestion. The DSC Road stretch between Botanical Garden and GIP Mall, Sector 62 and NH-9 also remained submerged. A nearly 50-metre portion of the central verge near Sector 16 Metro station collapsed during the showers, prompting the Noida Authority to begin repair work.

Taking serious note of the situation, Noida Authority CEO Krishna Karunesh dismissed junior engineer Parth Rathore and supervisor Mange Ram for negligence in Barola village. Adverse entries were issued against two managers, while a contractor was fined Rs 5 lakh and served a show-cause notice over poor-quality civic work.

OVER 17 LAKH WOMEN TO GET Rs 2,500 MONTHLY

Lakshmi arrives for Delhi women

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: After months of anticipation, the Delhi government on Tuesday unveiled the contours of its flagship Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, approving monthly financial assistance of Rs 2,500 for over 17 lakh eligible women. The scheme will open for applications from August 1, with the first payment targeted around Raksha Bandhan. The scheme was approved at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta at the Delhi Secretariat. The government has earmarked Rs 5,110 crore for the scheme in the 2026-27 Budget.

Announcing the decision, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the initiative marks a major step towards ensuring economic independence and social security for women. Gupta along with her cabinet colleagues celebrates the announcement of Delhi Lakshmi Yojana.

"The Delhi Lakshmi Yojana will lay the foundation for dignity and a brighter future for women," she said, adding that the government had fulfilled an important commitment made to



“The Delhi Lakshmi Yojana will lay the foundation for dignity and a brighter future for women — CM

the women of Delhi within just over a year of assuming office. The scheme will cover women aged 21 to 60 years whose annual family income does not exceed Rs 2.5 lakh.

It will initially remain in force for three years, with the possibility of extension or modification later.

The online application portal will open on August 1, and the government aims to release the first instalment on Raksha Bandhan. Applications will be processed through a district-level scrutiny mechanism to ensure transparency and speedy grievance redressal.

Beneficiaries will have two options for receiving the monthly assistance. Under the first, Rs.1,500 will be deposited

into a recurring or fixed deposit account, while Rs.1,000 will be credited to a Central Bank Digital Rupee Wallet, which can be used only for approved goods and services. Alternatively, women may opt to receive the entire Rs.2,500 in an RD or FD to promote long-term savings.

The government has excluded several categories from the scheme, including women already receiving financial assistance or pensions, income taxpayers, GST return filers, government employees, women with more than three living children, families consuming over 2,400 units of electricity annually, households owning a four-wheeler, families with a government employee, and women with a criminal record.

Besides financial support, the scheme also seeks to promote children's education, healthcare, immunisation, skill development, participation in self-help groups and public welfare campaigns, including Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam, Swachh Bharat Mission, and anti-single-use plastic initiatives.

Delhi House to meet Aug 7-11

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday approved the schedule for the Monsoon Session of the Delhi Legislative Assembly, which will be held from August 7 to August 11.

The decision was taken during a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta at the Delhi Secretariat. Announcing the decision, the CM said the five-day session would focus on key issues concerning Delhi's development and public welfare. According to the government, discussions during the session will cover matters of public importance, with the aim of taking decisions that serve the interests of the people. CM said the Assembly would witness "serious and meaningful discussions" on issues related to the city's development and welfare schemes. She reiterated that the government remains committed to placing public interest at the centre of its decision-making process and ensuring effective implementation of policies.

MPOST

L-G lays foundation stone for modern dog shelter in Dwarka

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday laid the foundation stone for a modern dog shelter at Sector 29, Dwarka, to be developed by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD). Spread across nearly 6,050 square metres, the facility aims to provide safe shelter, medical care and rehabilitation for stray dogs through modern infrastructure designed to improve animal welfare.

The foundation stone was laid in the presence of Delhi Mayor Praveesh Wahi, South Delhi MP Ramvir Singh Bidhuri, Najafgarh MLA Kailash Gahlot, MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar and other senior officials.

Addressing the gathering, the Lieutenant Governor said the project would be developed entirely through Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) support from the GMR Varalakshmi Foundation, ensuring that the MCD would not incur any expenditure. He described the initiative as a successful example of public-private partnership



and appreciated the Foundation's contribution towards strengthening animal welfare in the Capital.

The Lieutenant Governor directed that the shelter's operational strategy should be prepared in consultation with all stakeholders, including animal welfare groups, dog lovers, Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs), non-governmental organisations, veterinarians and subject experts. He said their experience would help ensure that the facility functions on scientific and compassionate principles.

During the visit, the Lieutenant Governor also inspected Delhi's only cremation centre for small animals and reviewed its

facilities. He emphasised that both the dog shelter and the cremation centre should be managed with empathy and not merely as civic infrastructure projects. Officials said the upcoming shelter would provide a safe environment for stray dogs while supporting their treatment, care and rehabilitation. The project is expected to become a model facility for humane and scientific management of stray animals in Delhi. The civic authorities said the initiative reflects the city's growing focus on animal welfare and underlines the belief that urban development should also be measured by the care extended to vulnerable and voiceless animals.

Delhi govt okays funds hike for Kanwar camps

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has decided to hike financial assistance for large Kanwar camps from Rs 11 lakh to Rs 15 lakh and to continue free electricity up to 1,200 units, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Tuesday.

Gupta chaired a cabinet meeting where a proposal to increase the financial assistance provided to Kanwar committees for Kanwar Yatra 2026 was approved.

"Keeping in view the growing number of devotees, the need to provide them with adequate facilities, and the rising cost of running the camps, the government has decided to enhance the grant for Kanwar camps across all categories.

Over 50 extra Namu Bharat trips from July 30 as NCRTC ramps up services for Kanwar Yatra

The existing provision of free electricity of up to 1,200 units for Kanwar committees will also continue," the chief minister's office said in a statement. Under the cabinet's decision, large Kanwar camps spread over more than 20,000 square feet and operating for six to twelve days will now be eligible for financial assistance of up to Rs 15 lakh, it added.

MPOST

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Stressing the importance of harmony between democratic institutions, Delhi Legislative Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Tuesday said the principle of separation of powers is meant to foster constitutional balance rather than institutional isolation, as the Assembly hosted 45 trainee judicial officers under its Youth Outreach Programme.

The visit, organised in collaboration with the Delhi Judicial Academy, has now been formally incorporated into the academy's annual training curriculum for judicial officers.

Addressing the participants, Gupta said, "India's constitutional democracy draws its

strength from institutions that remain faithful to their respective responsibilities while functioning with mutual respect. The Legislature and the Judiciary have distinct constitutional roles, but both are united by a common commitment to justice, accountability and the rule of law."

Emphasising constitutional principles, he added, "The principle of separation of powers does not imply institutional isolation. Rather, it provides a constitutional framework within which every organ of the State exercises its authority with restraint, responsibility and respect for the jurisdiction of the others." He also urged trainee judicial officers and law students to view law as an instrument for safeguarding

rights, resolving disputes and strengthening public confidence in institutions.

Former Lok Sabha Secretary General P. D. T. Acharya, speaking on "Legislature-Judiciary Interface: Separation of Powers in Practice, said, "The separation of powers under the Indian Constitution is not rigid, but rests on a carefully structured balance among the Legislature, the Executive and the Judiciary." Explaining the constitutional framework, he said legislatures make laws while courts interpret them, adding that ordinance-making under Article 123 reflects the functional overlap between institutions. He also referred to landmark cases, including the Keshav Singh case, and judicial interventions that strengthened

electoral transparency.

Deputy Speaker Mohan Singh Bisht said such interactions help judicial officers and law students understand legislative functioning and constitutional conventions. Principal Secretary (Law, Justice and Legislative Affairs) Reetesh Singh described the visit as the first institutional interaction of its kind for judicial officers at the Delhi Assembly and announced that Assembly visits have now been formally included in the Delhi Judicial Academy's training curriculum. The participants also toured the Assembly premises, viewed documentaries on Vithalbhai Patel and the Delhi Assembly, and attended a presentation on the coffee table book Ek Shatabdi Yatra.



‘MGNREGS HAS NOW BEEN REPLACED BY VB-GRAM G’

Average MGNREGS workdays fell to 43 in FY26, lowest in decade: Govt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Rural households received an average of 43 days of employment under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) in 2025-26, the lowest in a decade, according to data shared by the government in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday.

Replying to a starred question, Rural Development Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said the average number of workdays per household under the scheme declined from 50 days in 2024-25 to 43 days in 2025-26. Till June 2026, the average number of workdays was 24 in the current fiscal.

The data showed that the average number of workdays has fluctuated between 38 and 52 days since 2008-09, well below the statutory guarantee of 100 days under MGN-



REGS. The highest average of 52 days was recorded in 2020-21 and again in 2023-24, while the average stood at 50 days in 2024-25 before falling sharply in 2025-26. In 2008-09, the first year for which data was provided, households received an average of 38 days of employment.

Chouhan said MGNREGS has now been replaced by the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) under the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025.

“The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 provides for a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment in a financial year to every willing rural household demanding work, as against 100 days under the erstwhile MGNREGS,” he said.

He said the scope of work under the new programme had been “significantly expanded” to focus on water security, core rural infrastructure, livelihood infrastructure and mitigation of extreme weather events, while promoting convergence with central and state govern-

ment schemes. The minister also said the Centre had allocated Rs 95,692.31 crore for the programme for the nine-month period from July 1, 2026 to March 31, 2027.

Including the states’ share, the total outlay is expected to exceed Rs 1.51 lakh crore, he added.

On the financial implications of providing 125 days of employment, Chouhan said the annual budgetary requirement would depend on factors such as the actual demand for work,

wage rates, the nature of work undertaken, material expenditure and administrative costs.

The Centre replaced MGNREGS with VB-G RAM G through a law enacted last year. The new programme increases the employment guarantee from 100 to 125 days and government says it is designed to strengthen rural employment and create durable assets. Opposition parties and several civil society organisations have criticised the move, saying it weakens the rights-based framework of MGNREGS.

Highlights

» Shivraj Singh Chouhan said the average number of workdays per household under the scheme declined from 50 days in 2024-25 to 43 days in 2025-26

» The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 provides for a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment in a financial year to every willing rural household demanding work, as against 100 days under the erstwhile MGNREGS

Govt unveils policy reform for induction of officers into ICG

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday unveiled a policy reform for Indian Coast Guard, which will allow induction of women candidates into permanent appointments “at par with their male counterparts” and posting of women personnel aboard ICG ships in key roles, officials said.

The defence ministry also launched another policy reform that allows for declaring an ICG officer missing at sea while on duty as “presumed dead” for the purpose of ex gratia.

At an event held at Kartavya Bhavan-2 here, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh unveiled the two significant policy reforms for the ICG to promote “gender parity” in the induction and service conditions of officers, and streamlining the administrative procedures for granting ex gratia to the families of personnel reported missing at sea while on duty, the defence ministry said in a statement.

The first policy directive



Defence minister Rajnath Singh during the unveiling of two policy reforms for the Indian Coast Guard (ICG), in New Delhi

PTI

A senior official said the policy reform will allow induction of women candidates into Permanent Appointments at par with their male counterparts, as also posting of women personnel aboard ICG ships in “operational, executive, technical” and other key roles.

Now, they will also be able to get the “same level of training” as male personnel have been receiving, the officials said.

Previously, women personnel have been posted in “logistics role”, but with the new policy, “it really brings them at par, in every sense”, they said.

The ministry said this “progressive step reflects the government’s commitment to Nari Shakti and equal opportunity in the nation’s maritime security apparatus”.

The policy ensures “equal opportunities for career progression”, commencing right from the ab initio training phase. The existing PA women officers shall also be “considered for promotion to higher positions subject to fulfilment of eligibility conditions”, it said.

establishes a comprehensive, women-centric approach by ushering in a gender-neutral framework for the induction of officers into the Coast Guard, it said.

The highlights of the policy include induction of women candidates into both Short Service Appointments (SSA) and Permanent Appointments (PA) “at par with their male counterparts”, it said.

The ministry further said the SSA has also been “opened for male candidates”.

From Page 1

Anti-paper

Supporting the Bill, Shiv Sena MP Shrikant Shinde said there is a need to change the system of holding this exam on a specified day only.

Congress deputy leader Gaurav Gogoi questioned the proposed amendments to the anti-paper leak law, saying despite an existing law, question paper leaks of public examinations have continued and it has proved to be a failure.

Gogoi also said that students were compelled to hit the streets and their pain needs to be understood.

Accusing the Centre of failing to address the concerns of students, he said merely enhancing punishments and penalties will not curb paper leaks unless the education system is comprehensively reformed.

Samajwadi Party supremo Akhilesh Yadav said the government was rattled and was forced to bow down and accept the demands of the protesting students. He said the students’ stir on the NEET paper leak issue was the first such agitation supported by parents.

DMK MP Dayanidhi Maran reiterated his party’s demand for scrapping NEET, arguing that the proposed amendments to the anti-paper leak law do not address what he described as the fundamental problem with the medical entrance examination.

Maran said Tamil Nadu had consistently opposed NEET since its inception and accused the Centre of ignoring the state’s concerns.

“Enough is enough, ban NEET, abolish NEET. Do not go for ‘One India, One Examination’. Our strength comes from our diversity,” he said.

TDP MP Lavu Sri Krishna Devarayalu urged the government to conduct the NEET-UG examination multiple times a year instead of just once.

TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee, while extending support to the Bill, said the legislation will not wash away the 12 years of the “incompetence and failure” of the BJP-led Centre even as he extended his party’s support to the proposed legislation.

“It cannot erase the humiliation faced by lakhs of young Indians. It cannot erase images of students who came seeking justice and were met with barricades and pellet guns, instead of love and compassion,” he said.

SC orders release

It directed that Delhi government and other states may proceed with the investigation of the FIRs registered but no coercive measures shall be taken against the protesting students.

“Such protection, nonetheless, shall not be extended to the persons with criminal antecedents,” it clarified.

Noting that the bench is mulling an independent, a transparent and thorough probe into all allegations by a task force, the judges said a probe is also required to ascertain the attacks on 250 policemen and whether they were by students or some “miscreants”.

“Be that as it may, the allegations made by the petitioners, prima facie, establish a compelling case for an independent and impartial investigation into the incidents of violence. Such an investigation will adequately address the allegations presented by the family members of the police personnel, as well as the issues raised by the Solicitor General of India,” the bench said.

While posting the matter for further hearing on August 3, the top court said in the interest of justice it is giving an opportunity to the Centre and the states concerned to place their versions on record before it considers constituting an independent committee or a Special Investigation Team (SIT).

The top court issued notices to Maharashtra, Bihar, Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, West Bengal and Kerala and asked their advocates general to appear online on the next date of hearing.

The bench issued a slew of interim directions to states where protests were held to preserve CCTV footage, drone recordings, body-camera footage, wireless communication records, PCR logs and other digital evidence pertaining to the protests.

It also ordered the police authorities to ensure that the personal information and digital data of the protestors, collected during the students’ protests, are preserved and are not disclosed to the public domain for the time being.

The bench emphasised that the authorities may not publish any public data/details of the protestors, especially students.

“The NCT of Delhi and other states may proceed with the investigation of the FIRs registered; however, no coercive measures shall be taken against the protesting students. Such protection, nonetheless, shall not be extended to the persons with criminal antecedents,” it ordered.

After hearing arguments for various parties, the bench said, “The allegations prima facie warrant consideration of a fair and independent probe, which must also address the concerns of families of over 200 injured police personnel.”

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said students will not indulge in violence against police personnel but some “miscreants” were involved in violent incidents.

NEET protest

The petition filed by Yashovardhan Azad, Prashant Kumar and Sheikh Irshad Mansoori through advocate Vrinda Grover sought direction for decommissioning or banning the use of wholly or partly metallic kinetic projectiles/pellets fired from pump action rifles or projectile action guns (PAG) for crowd dispersal of civilian assemblies by law enforcement agencies and other connected reliefs.

Kumar, 25, is an artist who was present at the Sansad Chalo march on July 20 as a peaceful protester and claimed to have received pellet injuries from RAF firing without any provocation or aggression from his end, the plea said.

It also said that Mansoori, 26, on the other hand, was present at Connaught Place in the Capital on July 20 after attending to passport and visa-related work in the region and had received pellet injuries from RAF firing despite no provocation or aggression from his end.

The plea said, “On July 20, 2026, during the ‘Sansad Chalo’ march

organised by the Cockroach Janta Party as part of a protest regarding rampant paper leaks wrecking the credibility of higher education in India, the Delhi Police used the assistance of the CRPF’s Rapid Action Force (RAF) for crowd management.

“The Petitioners No. 2 and 3 personally witnessed that around 4-4.30 pm on that day, the police and the RAF personnel incessantly fired tear gas shells and resorted to lathicharge and pushed the protesters towards the Inner Circle of Connaught Place, New Delhi.”

The court also agreed to hear the plea moved by Junaid Malik, a volunteer who provided food during the protests and has alleged illegal detention, intimidation and coercive action against him and his family members.

He alleged that he was picked up by Delhi Police officials around midnight on July 24 while returning from Ram Manohar Lohia (RML) Hospital after receiving an anti-rabies injection.

Malik claimed he was confined inside a police vehicle for nearly five to six hours, during which he was allegedly threatened and intimidated. His mobile phone was forcibly unlocked and searched, with officers repeatedly questioning him about the funding and sources of money for supplying food to protestors.

Appearing for Malik, advocate Prashant Bhushan submitted that his client was “taken blindfolded to Mussoorie”.

The CJP-led march on July 20 in Delhi witnessed clashes between protestors and security personnel, who used lathis and teargas shells to disperse crowds attempting to move towards Parliament complex.

Jantar Mantar

RAF inspector’s team have been identified. The post-assessment report submitted to headquarters will mention the officer to whom the pump-action guns were issued, along with the specific number of pellet cartridges. The inquiry has also found several deviations, including personnel not firing below the waist,” an official familiar with the probe said.

“But one thing is certain: no pellet guns were issued on Thursday, Friday or Saturday after the controversy. They will not be issued during future student protests unless the opposing group is armed,” the official added.

Between 1 pm and 5 pm on July 20, the RAF team under scrutiny was deployed near the Grand Charkha installation above Palika Bazar on the road leading from Connaught Place to Jantar Mantar.

“We have learnt that personnel told the internal inquiry the pellet gun was fired after a Delhi Police team came under stone-pelting and the crowd also targeted RAF personnel. They also said they had to escalate their response because Parliament was in session and protesters were attempting to march towards the Parliament complex,” another official said.

CRPF headquarters is yet to receive the inquiry report from RAF Inspector General Seema Dhundia. Officials said Dhundia held separate review meetings last Thursday and Friday, one with RAF officers and another with the CRPF’s senior leadership.

According to a Hindustan Times report, the review found several departures from standard

operating procedures. Following the meetings, all CRPF and RAF personnel were directed to wear name tags on their uniforms from Friday.

“During the review, it was also found that some personnel were giving interviews at the protest site or posting on social media. This is against service rules,” the second official said.

The July 20 incident was entered in the general diary of Parliament Street police station at 1.24 pm on July 22 based on information provided by a Deputy Commandant-rank RAF officer, officials told PTI. According to the entry, RAF personnel in blue dungarees were deployed in Zone 1 of the Jantar Mantar area alongside a Delhi Police officer of Deputy Commissioner of Police rank.

On the directions of the DCP, RAF personnel fired 55 non-electrical shells, 15 electrical shells, five tear smoke grenades, two rounds from anti-riot guns and two rounds of plastic pellets on July 20, according to officials citing the police station records. It was not immediately known whether RAF units fired additional pellet rounds at other protest sites.

Delhi Police has maintained that allegations of pellet use against “peaceful protesters” are “completely false and misleading”.

The CRPF and the RAF have not commented specifically on allegations regarding the use of pellet guns.

Officials said each round of plastic pellets contains four pellets. Unlike metal pellets, plastic pellets do not pierce the body and are considered less likely to cause serious injuries.

The alleged use of force, particularly plastic pellets, has become another flashpoint, with the Opposition targeting the government and demanding a statement from Union Home Minister Amit Shah in Parliament. Several Delhi Police, RAF and CRPF personnel were also injured during the protests.

CRPF Director General G P Singh said the force was conducting a professional assessment of the operation.

“Now, since the agitation has been called off and the assembled people have dispersed, we will carry out a professional post-event assessment, as we do after every major assignment, and then let you know the view of the Force Headquarters,” Singh said.

CJP seeks govt

and investigations, had created “serious concerns” among protesters.

“The interim order passed by the Supreme Court of India in the batch of PILs related to the CJP protest must ring alarm bells across the country,” Das said in a post on X. He claimed that the direction appeared to contradict the assurance given by the government on July 25 that FIRs against peaceful protesters would be withdrawn and no participant would be targeted for taking part in the agitation.

The CJP had ended its nationwide protest in “good faith” after receiving the government’s assurance, Das said, adding that the commitment made to thousands of students “cannot be diluted, undermined or rendered meaningless through legal developments”.

However, he clarified that the Supreme Court had not directed governments to continue with FIRs and that authorities still had the

power to withdraw cases or decide not to proceed against protesters, as done by Bihar and Assam.

“The court has not mandated that governments must definitely continue with the FIRs. That would be a deliberate misreading,” Das said.

He urged the Centre and state governments to place details of the assurance given to protesters before the Supreme Court to ensure transparency.

“If the guarantees are dishonoured, the Cockroach Janta Party will have no option but to resume its nationwide protest,” Das said, warning that “the streets of India will once again become the voice of its young”.

Earlier in the day, the Supreme Court directed the Delhi Police and governments of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Assam, West Bengal and Kerala to immediately release all students detained or arrested during the ‘Sansad Chalo’ protest on July 20 and subsequent days, provided they had no criminal antecedents.

Meanwhile, the CJP also criticised BJP MP Kangana Ranaut over her remarks against protesters, after she described some participants as “Generation Gutter”.

Ranaut, in an Instagram post, had criticised the language used during CJP-led protests, calling it “puke-inducing” and “crass”. She questioned the upbringing of protesters and alleged that some young participants had little to contribute to society.

Responding to her comments, Das said Ranaut lacked seriousness and claimed that even people within her own party did not take her remarks seriously.

“She calls us an ‘unserious generation’, yet she exposed her own lack of seriousness,” Das said, adding that politicians should maintain dignity while speaking about young citizens. The controversy came amid renewed tensions after the CJP alleged that assurances given during negotiations were being breached.

In a late-night video message, Das said party representatives had raised concerns with government officials over reports of arrests and harassment of protesters in some states. He said the government reiterated its commitment to withdrawing cases, releasing detained protesters and ensuring similar protections through notifications from more states.

Das said officials had shared Bihar’s order withdrawing FIRs against protesters, and discussions were held on extending similar safeguards elsewhere.

“We told them that we were worried the assurances given by the government may not be fulfilled,” he said.

Centre summons

first direct selfie video aimed at connecting with young people. In the video, he announced that the government would introduce a Bill in Parliament providing for strong action against paper leaks and said its framework would be finalised at the next day’s Union Cabinet meeting.

The removal of the post drew criticism from BJP worker Priti Gandhi, who questioned Meta’s actions on X. “The Prime Minister of the world’s largest democracy uploads his first direct selfie video to connect with India’s youth...

and Facebook restricts it??? Who gave Meta the authority to decide what millions of Indians should or should not see???” she wrote. She added that the incident raised questions about the company’s “political bias, transparency & accountability”.

Meta later apologised, saying,

“The content was removed in error and has since been restored.”

The July 23 video was posted during student protests organised by the Cockroach Janta Party.

The latest episode comes amid heightened government scrutiny of Meta. In recent weeks, the IT Ministry questioned WhatsApp’s proposed username feature over fraud and impersonation risks, directed Instagram to act against child sexual exploitative and abuse material in paid advertisements, and reviewed Meta’s Muse AI image generator before the company withdrew the feature following criticism over privacy, image scraping and consent concerns. The Centre has also increased oversight of digital platforms, with greater attention to accountability, transparency, privacy and user safeguards in the AI era.

MPOST

No more multiple

on the use of staff cars. The latest order supplements the comprehensive instructions issued on September 1, 2022, which consolidated the Centre’s rules governing official vehicles.

Under the revised norms, an officer already entitled to an official staff car cannot be allotted another government vehicle simply because they have been given additional charge of another ministry, department, PSU or autonomous body. Instead, the officer must continue using the staff car already assigned to them. The memorandum also bars central government officers from using vehicles belonging to PSUs, autonomous bodies or quasi-government organisations, except while travelling on official duty or during authorised tours. Ministries have also been instructed to keep surplus or unused vehicles in safe custody instead of allowing them to be put to unofficial use.

The Department of Expenditure said the revised instructions are intended to improve administrative efficiency, prevent misuse of government resources and reduce avoidable expenditure on official transport.

It said the “One Entitled Officer, One Official Car” principle is expected to streamline the management of staff cars across ministries and departments while promoting fiscal discipline.

The government has also reiterated that all ministries and departments must ensure strict compliance with the revised norms, reinforcing the directions contained in the Master Office Memorandum issued in September 2022 on the use of official staff cars across Central government offices.

Sharmila

behind Malaysia’s Erry Hidayat Muhammad, who set a Games record of 331kg. Their contest saw the Games record revised several times before the Malaysian sealed victory with his final lift. Ajaya Babu’s silver raised India’s weightlifting haul to six medals after

Gyaneshwari Yadav won silver and Bindyarani Devi claimed bronze on Monday.

India calls PoK

disputed by the authorities. Addressing a weekly media briefing, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India’s position on Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh remained unchanged.

“The current cosmetic electoral exercise is nothing but an attempt by Pakistan to camouflage its illegal occupation and hide its grave human rights violations in the region,” he said.

Jaiswal reiterated that the entire Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, including the areas under Pakistan’s “illegal and forcible occupation”, are “integral and inalienable parts of India”. He also said the continuing protests in Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir reflected Pakistan’s “economic exploitation”, denial of fundamental rights and administrative oppression.

The developments came as violence broke out near Rawalakot, where thousands of JAAC supporters attempted to march towards Muzaffarabad after weeks of demonstrations. According to the group, Pakistani security forces opened fire on participants of what it described as a peaceful procession, killing at least 14 activists. A post by the JAAC on X later claimed that at least 20 people had died and that 19 victims had been identified.

Authorities in PoK rejected the casualty figures. Police chief Captain (retd.) Liaquat Ali Malik told BBC Urdu that the administration had received no bodies in any government or private hospital and therefore could not verify the deaths. He said two police officers were injured in the clashes and were being treated at the Combined Military Hospital in Rawalpindi.

A district administration official also claimed that a Pakistan Rangers officer was killed and several security personnel were injured after protesters allegedly opened fire. The official said demonstrators also torched two Rangers and police vehicles. Security forces had reportedly blocked around 2,000 protesters near the Rawalakot bus terminal and another 3,000 marchers camped at Dreak, where the JAAC has maintained a protest site for more than six weeks.

The JAAC rejected the official account. Core committee member Abid Shaheen alleged that security personnel fired “without provocation” on a peaceful march and vowed that the procession would continue until it reached Muzaffarabad. BBC Urdu said it could not independently verify the competing claims made by the protesters and the authorities.

Responding to questions on the Indus Waters Treaty, Jaiswal rejected suggestions by some Pakistani commentators about a shared Indus Valley civilisation. “A country which has been promoting cross-border terrorism, which has been promoting religious fundamentalism and violence for decades, cannot have any claim to any pluralistic cultural legacy,” he said, adding that Pakistan’s record on protecting minorities made such claims “phony”. He also said India’s younger generation was well aware of Pakistan’s role in sponsoring cross-border terrorism and hoped people across the border would take note of that sentiment.

FOREIGN SECRETARY'S BEIJING VISIT

India, China reaffirm focus on peace along border

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India and China discussed ways to deepen bilateral ties during Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri's visit to Beijing, echoing the shared vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Xi Jinping that both nations are development partners.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said both sides acknowledged the importance of maintaining peace and tranquillity in the India-China border areas.

"Both sides discussed bilateral relations in its entirety and discussed means of advancing the vision of the two leaders (Modi and Xi) that India and China are partners and development opportunities for each other, including through mutually beneficial outcomes across trade and economic ties, culture and people-to-people



Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri during a meeting with China's Vice Foreign Minister Hua Chunying, in Beijing, China, Monday

exchanges," Jaiswal said at a media briefing. On India and China deciding to resume border trade

through Nathu La, Jaiswal said: "This is matter which was agreed between two side last year. In August 2025, Both sides

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Misri is on a two-day visit to China from Monday
- » He held talks with a number of Chinese leaders, including Vice Foreign Minister Hua Chunying
- » Both sides discussed bilateral relations in its entirety
- » They discussed means of advancing the vision of the two leaders (Modi and Xi) that India and China are partners

and Nathu La Pass."

Misri on Tuesday wrapped up his visit to Beijing after two days of extensive discussions with several Chinese officials on the entire spectrum of India-China relations.

The visit by Misri, who was previously India's Ambassador to China, came as the two countries have stepped up bilateral engagement.

Earlier in the day, he met Li Wentang, Vice President of the ruling Communist Party's Central Party School in Beijing and discussed opportunities for future cooperation and exchanges. During the meeting, Misri was briefed about the school's historical significance, intellectual contributions and academic programmes, according to a social media post by the Indian embassy here.

He concluded his China visit after meeting with Li, official sources said.

On Monday, Misri met other Chinese leaders, including Vice Foreign Minister Hua Chunying, with whom he discussed the entire gamut of the bilateral relations.

The foreign secretary also met Sun Haiyan, Vice Minister of the International Department of the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China and Hong Liang, Deputy Secretary General of the 14th National Committee of the Chinese People's Political Consultative Conference.

Hong was previously the Director General of the boundary department of the Chinese Foreign Ministry.

Misri's visit followed the meeting between External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on the sidelines of meetings related to the Association of Southeast Asian Nations in Manila on July 21.

Rain triggers flash floods & landslides in Himalayan states

U'khand, HP among worst affected



People gather on the Parmarth Niketan Ghat amid rising water levels following rainfall in Rishikesh

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Rain lashed parts of northern India on Tuesday, triggering landslides and flash floods in the Himalayan states.

The IMD has forecast above-normal rainfall over northwest and central India in the next 4-5 days, fairly widespread rainfall in eastern India in the next 5-6 days, and isolated to scattered rainfall across Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram & Tripura, and the southern peninsula.

The Himalayan states of Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh were among the worst affected. In Himachal, moderate to heavy rains caused landslides in Chamba district, where about a dozen vehicles and many houses were buried in debris. However, no loss of life has been reported so far.

According to the state emergency operation centre (SEOC), a total of 108 roads were closed due to landslides and flash floods triggered by torrential rains on Monday evening, while 38 water supply schemes and nine transformers have been disrupted.

The Met office said there was a moderate flash-flood

threat in a few watersheds and neighbourhoods in seven out of 12 districts in the state, namely Chamba, Kangra, Kullu, Mandi, Shimla, Sirmour and Solan, in the next 24 hours.

An orange warning was issued for heavy to very heavy rains in isolated areas of four to five districts of Himachal Pradesh till July 30 and on August 3.

In Uttarakhand, heavy rains continued to batter the hilly state. Officials suspended the Char Dham Yatra for two days due to landslides blocking pilgrimage routes and a heavy rain alert, an officer said.

Garhwal Commissioner Anand Swaroop said the Char Dham Yatra has been suspended for Tuesday and Wednesday for the safety of pilgrims. The yatra routes have been blocked at several locations due to landslides and a heavy rainfall alert has also been issued by the weather department, he said.

The pilgrimage will resume once the weather conditions improve and the routes are deemed safe, the officer said.

Rains also lashed many places in Punjab and Haryana, bringing relief from the ongoing hot weather.

No paper leak in Punjab: Mann

NEW DELHI: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday claimed that there has been no paper leak under his government and accused the BJP of trying to defame Punjabis for its own political gains.

Addressing the media here after meeting Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla in the Parliament complex, Mann said the BJP is making "false allegations" about paper leaks to defame Punjabis and warned that this will cost them dearly.

He also met some opposition MPs during his visit to Parliament House, including Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav.

The chief minister said the BJP should "stop maligning Punjabis" for political gains and fight its political battle with him instead. The BJP, the Congress and Shiromani Akali

Mann said the BJP is making 'false allegations' to defame Punjabis

Dal have alleged paper leaks in Punjab's medical examination and are demanding the resignation of the education minister in the state. Punjab goes to polls early next year.

Mann hit out at the BJP, the Congress and SAD for allegedly trying to tarnish the reputation of Punjab and its hardworking youth through false paper leak allegations. The chief minister said his government has provided 69,000 government jobs solely on the basis of merit.

"The beauty of democracy is that people should continue to meet and interact with

each other. Differences in ideology are natural in politics and they will always exist," Mann said.

Referring to the opposition's allegations over paper leaks, the Punjab CM said, "Our government has completed four-and-a-half years in office, but not a single examination paper has leaked in Punjab during this period." "A few days ago, we did detect a case of cheating during a pharmacy examination. The exam started at 11 am, and by 11:15 am we had found that a candidate was using a Bluetooth-enabled pen to scan the question paper and receive answers through an earpiece from people sitting outside. The Punjab Police acted immediately, arrested 10 candidates along with an 11-member gang operating from outside," he said.

CBI files chargesheet against 13 accused in NEET paper leak case

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The CBI has filed a chargesheet against 13 accused in the NEET-UG 2026 question paper leak case.

The chargesheet invokes provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) relating to criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust and destruction of evidence, besides sections of the Prevention of Corruption Act and the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. All 13 accused are currently in judicial custody.

The agency has cited 360 witnesses, 422 documents and 43 material objects as evidence against the accused. It said digital forensic reports, handwriting expert opinions and inputs

from academic experts established that the question paper was circulated before the examination began.

The NEET examination was held on May 3. The CBI registered an FIR after receiving a complaint from the Higher Education Department on May 12 regarding alleged irregularities and a possible paper leak. Investigation teams comprising 72 members and eight cyber forensic experts were constituted. During the probe, the agency conducted searches at 92 locations across Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Haryana, Delhi and several other states. Electronic devices, communication instruments and documents seized during the searches were sent for forensic examination.

The CBI said it traced the

source of the question paper within weeks of registering the FIR and subsequently followed the trail to beneficiary candidates allegedly involved in the cheating network.

A major crackdown began on May 13, when the agency arrested three National Testing Agency subject experts from Chemistry, Biology and Physics. Several middlemen and two persons linked to coaching institutes allegedly involved in obtaining the question paper were also arrested. As part of its probe into the financial trail, the CBI attached several bank accounts, bank lockers and a demat account linked to the alleged proceeds of the crime.

The agency said it has concluded the investigation for the time being.

Haryana unveils ambitious MSME, export policy

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Haryana government on Tuesday unveiled the Progressive MSME & Export Promotion Policy 2026, one of the state's most ambitious frameworks for strengthening micro, small and medium enterprises and expanding exports.

The policy places more than 14 lakh MSMEs at the centre of Haryana's growth strategy and introduces 60 initiatives across finance, infrastructure, technology, exports, sustainability and skills. It targets over Rs 55,000 crore in manufacturing investment, creation of more than five lakh jobs and doubling of the state's exports over the next five years. The policy aligns with commitments under the Sankalp Patra, announcements in the State Budget 2026-27, Haryana Vision 2047 and the Centre's Raising and Accelerating MSME Performance (RAMP)



programme.

Support has been extended to traditional and high-growth sectors, including automotive and auto components, electric vehicles, aerospace and defence, engineering, pharmaceuticals, medical devices, electronics, textiles, renewable energy, green industries and agri-based and food-processing sectors. The Haryana Agri-Business and Food Processing Policy 2026 will complement the MSME framework.

Under the Haryana Udyam Vikas Mission, MSMEs and exporters in identified thrust sectors will be eligible for capital investment subsidies under

a dedicated state-wide programme. The policy also provides interest subsidies, stamp duty reimbursement, employment generation support, insurance assistance and incentives for testing, automation, artificial intelligence and research and development.

To improve access to finance, the government proposes a State Venture Capital Fund and a Sectoral Credit Guarantee Fund to facilitate institutional and collateral-free lending. The policy also seeks to reduce business costs by expanding cluster-based industrial infrastructure. Existing Cluster Plug & Play and Common Facility Centre schemes will be scaled up to provide MSMEs access to shared machinery, testing, design and other facilities at affordable costs.

A comprehensive export promotion framework will support enterprises with international quality certifications,

export credit, insurance, freight assistance, e-commerce registration and participation in global trade fairs. The Mukhya Mantri Pratham Nirayak Prot-sahan Yojana will specifically support first-time exporters.

The Haryana Nirayat Centre will serve as a one-stop facility for export documentation, regulatory compliance, certification, logistics, market intelligence and buyer connections. The Udaan Dwaar platform will facilitate export matchmaking, international joint ventures, technology partnerships and investor engagement.

The policy also promotes green manufacturing through support for energy efficiency, renewable energy, cleaner production, circular economy practices, Effluent Treatment Plants and Zero Liquid Discharge systems. A dedicated Green Investment Fund will support sustainable manufacturing and green innovation.

GOVT INFORMS TOP COURT

AI-171 crash: AAIB's draft final probe report will be filed in Oct

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday was apprised by the government that the draft final report of the probe conducted by the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) into the June 2025 Air India flight AI-171 crash in Ahmedabad will be filed before it in the first week of October in a sealed cover.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also took note of the submissions of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta that the Federation of Indian Pilots can provide its inputs to the AAIB which, in turn, can peruse and deal with them if found necessary during the investigation.

During a brief hearing, the solicitor general told the bench that four simulation tests have been conducted as sought in an application by one of the petitioners. The law officer said that the final draft report will be filed before the bench in a sealed cover.

The court was hearing petitions filed by an NGO, a law student and the father of the deceased pilot, seeking an independent, court-monitored investigation into the crash.

The bench has now posted the pleas for further hearing on October 13.

Recently, the AAIB filed an affidavit in the top court saying that the draft final report of the probe into the crash in Ahmed-

abad, which killed 260 people, is expected to be ready in October. The AAIB had said there is an "absolute statutory prohibition" on disclosing cockpit voice recordings and airborne image recordings from the June 12, 2025, Ahmedabad plane crash to any external committee or the public.

It had said that sharing such material would violate Rule 17(1) and Rule 17(5) read with Schedule C of the Aircraft (Investigation of Accidents and Incidents) Rules, 2025.

Prior to this, bench had asked the Centre to file a brief report on the "procedural protocol" followed so far, after it was informed that the investigation into the crash by the AAIB is at its fag end.

'DECLARE IT STANDALONE OFFENCE'

Apex Court asks Centre to consider defining digital arrest in criminal law

MPOST BUREU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday said that the Centre may consider formally defining digital arrest in criminal law and declaring it as a standalone offence with harsher punishments.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said that once there is prima facie material against an accused based on reasoned evidence, authorities could consider freezing the person's assets.

Digital arrest is a growing cybercrime in which fraudsters pose as police officers, court officials or personnel of government agencies and intimidate victims through audio and video calls. The victims are allegedly kept under virtual "custody" and pressured into transferring money.

"You may need to formally define 'digital arrests' in penal laws? It also has elements of extortion, robbery. Perhaps, you need to define this as a

KEY POINTS

- » Digital arrest is a growing cybercrime in which fraudsters pose as police officers or personnel of govt agencies and intimidate victims through audio and video calls
- » The victims are allegedly kept under virtual 'custody' and pressured into transferring money



FILE PIC

standalone offence with serious consequences, along with a provision that when something is found against an accused, his assets could be frozen," Chief Justice Kant suggested.

Attorney General R Venkataramani told the court that digital arrest was already covered under existing laws and said an Inter-Departmental Committee was finalising a comprehensive report to identify gaps in the system.

Justice Bagchi also raised concerns over deepfakes, saying emerging forms of online crime required legislative intervention. "We now have deepfakes. It can be used for cheating

and impersonation. You fight with the given tooth, but you need to chisel it as well. Under Article 142, we cannot define a crime," he said.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the government was working on legislation dealing with digital arrests, deepfakes and other online offences. "There is a draft bill which is coming up. Possibly it will take care of digital arrests, deepfakes etc and other online crimes," Mehta said.

Venkataramani informed the bench that the CBI was investigating around 20 major digital fraud cases involving losses of Rs 10 crore or more,

while other cases were being investigated by state police.

Seeking stronger safeguards, the Attorney General urged the court to direct the Reserve Bank of India to formally adopt and implement a standard operating procedure for banks to temporarily put debit restrictions on accounts suspected to be mule accounts used in cyber frauds.

He also sought directions to states, Union Territories and law enforcement agencies to expedite the operationalisation of grievance redressal and money restoration mechanisms.

The bench said it would issue directions in the matter on Wednesday.

CHANDIGARH: The Haryana Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, on Tuesday approved a series of measures covering affordable housing, governance, welfare, employment and electric mobility.

In a major relief to beneficiaries of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Urban 2.0, the Cabinet reduced stamp duty and registration charges for Economically Weaker Section beneficiaries purchasing eligible dwelling units of up to 60 square metres. They will now pay only Rs 500 each as stamp duty and registration fee per conveyance deed, against the existing 5 per cent stamp duty, 2 per cent additional duty and slab-based registration charges.

The Cabinet approved a Bill to establish Kusum International University in Rewari and the draft Haryana Local Audit Bill, 2026, providing a statutory framework for independent audits of local bodies and institutions receiving public funds. It also approved Rs 7.5 lakh compensation for legal heirs of persons dying due to unnatural causes in police custody, including torture, suicide, detainee quarrels or police negligence. In torture cases, at least half the compensation will be recovered from guilty police

INSIGHT

- » Series of measures covering affordable housing, governance, welfare, employment and electric mobility approved
- » New electric 2-, 3- and 4-wheelers costing up to Rs 30 lakh will get 100% exemption from motor vehicle tax

officials.

The Cabinet extended 20 per cent horizontal reservation for Haryana-domicile ex-Agniveers in recruitment to Fire Operator-cum-Driver, Wildlife Guard, Indian Reserve Battalion Constable and State Disaster Response Force posts.

Rules under the Haryana Abadi Deh Act, 2025, were approved to create legal ownership records for properties in Lal Dora areas. The Cabinet also reduced mandatory training for Patwaris from 18 months to one year. Trainee Patwaris will receive regular salaries instead of stipends, while their post-training pay scale has been upgraded.

The government approved 22 posts of Senior Radiology Officer and redesignated

Radiographers as Radiology Officers. To encourage women's vehicle ownership, a one per cent motor vehicle tax rebate was approved for non-transport vehicles costing up to Rs 20 lakh and registered in women's names. For electric mobility, new electric two-, three- and four-wheelers costing up to Rs 30 lakh will get 100 per cent exemption from motor vehicle tax. EVs above Rs 30 lakh will receive a 50 per cent exemption, while the existing 20 per cent rebate for CNG vehicles will continue.

The Cabinet also approved the Haryana State Commission for Minorities Bill, 2026, providing for the establishment of a statutory commission to safeguard the rights and welfare of minority communities.

In addition, it relaxed provisions of the compassionate appointment policy to allow three Haryana domicile dependents of martyred Armed Forces and CAPF personnel, who were minors at the time of their parents' death, to be considered for Group-C government jobs after attaining adulthood.

The Cabinet also gave in-principle approval to a new formula-based property tax assessment system for urban local bodies, replacing the existing 2013 mechanism. MPOST



EDITORIAL

BALANCED JUSTICE?

The Supreme Court's intervention in the aftermath of the nationwide student protests over the NEET paper leak is more than an interim judicial order. It is an attempt to restore constitutional balance after weeks in which allegations of excessive force, arbitrary arrests and administrative overreach threatened to overshadow the original issue that brought thousands of young people to the streets. By directing states not to take coercive action against student protesters, ordering the release of minors without criminal antecedents, preserving digital evidence and signalling the possibility of a Special Investigation Team (SIT), the Court has reminded both the State and the protesters that democratic dissent cannot be separated from accountability.

The protests themselves arose from a crisis of public trust. The alleged irregularities in one of India's most consequential competitive examinations struck at the heart of meritocracy. For millions of students, entrance examinations are not merely tests but gateways that shape careers and social mobility. When questions emerge over fairness, transparency and integrity, the consequences extend beyond academic institutions. They affect confidence in public administration itself. It was therefore inevitable that anger would spill onto the streets. What began as a demand for accountability in the conduct of examinations gradually transformed into a broader movement questioning institutional responsiveness.

However, every democracy faces the same difficult question: how should the State respond when public protest grows in scale and intensity? Governments have an undeniable duty to maintain public order, protect public property and ensure that essential services continue uninterrupted. Police personnel too have rights. They are entitled to safety while performing their duties, and any violence directed at them deserves impartial investigation and legal action. The Supreme Court has rightly acknowledged this aspect by noting allegations that hundreds of police personnel suffered injuries and by insisting that any independent investigation must examine those claims with equal seriousness. Justice cannot become selective merely because one side commands greater public sympathy.

Yet the authority to maintain order cannot become a licence for disproportionate force. The allegations placed before the Court—including the reported use of pellet guns, rubber bullets, electric batons and other methods causing serious injuries—raise disturbing questions about the principles governing crowd control in India. Whether each allegation ultimately withstands judicial scrutiny remains to be seen. But the very fact that the Court found a prima facie case warranting an independent investigation reflects the seriousness of the concerns. Democratic policing requires calibrated responses based on necessity, proportionality and restraint. If those principles are abandoned, law enforcement risks becoming punitive rather than preventive.

The Court's emphasis on preserving CCTV footage, drone recordings, body-camera videos, wireless communications and other digital records is equally significant. In the digital age, accountability increasingly depends upon objective evidence rather than competing narratives. Governments, police authorities, protesters and political organisations often present sharply conflicting versions of events after public demonstrations. Digital evidence offers the possibility of separating fact from allegation. Preservation of such material prevents selective disclosure and protects the integrity of future investigations. Equally important is the Court's direction against public disclosure of protesters' personal data. In an era when digital profiling can produce long-lasting consequences, privacy becomes an essential component of civil liberty.

Perhaps the most important constitutional principle reaffirmed by the judgment is the distinction between peaceful dissent and criminal conduct. The Court has not granted blanket immunity. Its protection explicitly excludes individuals with criminal antecedents and allows investigations into registered cases to continue. That balance is crucial. Democracies cannot function if violence committed during protests goes unpunished. Equally, they cannot survive if participation in peaceful demonstrations becomes sufficient reason for arrest, intimidation or prolonged legal harassment. The Constitution protects the right to assemble peacefully, not the right to commit violence. At the same time, it also restrains governments from treating every dissenter as a criminal suspect.

The Court's observation that India now requires uniform protocols governing protests deserves careful attention. Across states, policing practices vary considerably depending upon administrative culture, political context and operational discretion. Some demonstrations conclude peacefully through negotiation, while others escalate rapidly into confrontation. The absence of nationally accepted operational standards often leaves officers making split-second decisions under intense pressure without clear guidance on proportionality. Codified protocols covering crowd management, use of force, documentation, medical assistance, detention procedures and post-event accountability would reduce ambiguity for both police and citizens. Such guidelines would also strengthen judicial oversight by providing measurable benchmarks against which official conduct could be assessed.

This episode should also prompt deeper reflection on governance beyond policing. Public protests of this magnitude rarely emerge in isolation. They often reflect accumulated frustration over perceived institutional failures, delayed responses and inadequate communication. When examination controversies persist without timely transparency, rumours flourish and confidence erodes. Governments frequently underestimate the speed with which public distrust spreads in an age dominated by social media and instant communication. Early disclosure of facts, credible investigations and visible accountability can often prevent discontent from escalating into mass mobilisation. Administrative credibility remains the strongest antidote to unrest.

The proposed SIT, if ultimately constituted, will therefore carry responsibilities extending well beyond identifying individual culpability. Its credibility will depend upon independence, transparency and procedural fairness. It must examine allegations against police personnel wherever evidence warrants, investigate attacks on law enforcement officers with equal determination and distinguish between organised violence and legitimate protest. The objective cannot be to vindicate one narrative over another but to establish a comprehensive factual record that commands public confidence. Only an investigation perceived as impartial can restore trust in institutions already strained by controversy.

The larger lesson from this episode is that constitutional democracy requires restraint from all participants. Protesters must recognise that public support weakens when demonstrations descend into violence. Governments must remember that coercion often amplifies rather than resolves political grievances. Police forces require operational clarity, legal protection and professional training that emphasises de-escalation over confrontation. Courts, meanwhile, remain the constitutional safeguard when competing rights collide.

The Supreme Court's interim directions neither resolve the controversy surrounding the NEET paper leak nor settle every allegation arising from the protests. They do, however, reaffirm a principle that deserves to outlast this particular crisis: in a constitutional democracy, the legitimacy of State power is measured not only by its ability to enforce the law but also by its willingness to remain bound by it. That principle, more than any immediate political outcome, will determine whether public faith in India's democratic institutions emerges weakened or strengthened from this turbulent chapter.

INDUSTRIAL POLICY



PARTHA SARATHI BHATTACHARYYA

THE WRITER IS A FORMER CHAIRMAN, COAL INDIA LIMITED AND IS CURRENTLY THE CHAIRMAN OF PEERLESS GROUP

The decline of MAMC reflected a missed industrial transition. Its surviving land holdings could now become part of a very different conversation about manufacturing and investment in Bengal

Bengal's Next Industrial Chapter

Calls for large-scale industrialisation inevitably return to one persistent constraint — land. The former MAMC campus offers an opportunity for productive industrial reuse

Dr. Ashoke Lahiri, Vice Chairman, NITI Aayog, delivered a seminal talk titled 'Road Maps for Resurgence of Bengal' on July 25 at Bengal Club, Kolkata, at the invitation of Bangla Worldwide. The talk covered a wide range of issues craving attention. One of the main planks was the setting up of large industries for the creation of skilled employment. The availability of large stretches of land was mentioned as a constraint, for which necessary policy-level changes were advocated.

In this context, it is worthwhile to note that Bengal was home to several large industries a few decades ago, many of which have withered away over the years. The land holdings of these industries may still be available, at least in part, net of the quantum already lost to land sharks.

One such large tract of land belonged to Mining & Allied Machinery Corporation (MAMC), a PSU under the Ministry of Heavy Industries, Government of India. Built in the 1950s, the company had an impressive range of tie-ups for technical collaboration with international manufacturers of underground mining equipment from the UK, Poland, Germany, and the then USSR. Over the initial years, it built the capability to manufacture equipment for the mechanisation of underground mines.

In the early 1970s, the coal industry was nationalised. With coal being identified as the mainstay of the energy sector, the need for faster growth in coal production was emphasised. As a result, the focus swiftly shifted from mechanised underground mines to opencast mining. Indigenous capability for the manufacture of opencast mining equipment was created in BEML, another PSU based in Bangalore, as well as in private companies such as Caterpillar. Unfortunately, MAMC did not see the writing on the wall and failed to diversify into opencast equipment.



Whether the MAMC land remains available—and in what condition—is now as much a policy question as an administrative one

A rapid decline in sales followed. Eventually, the company became sick and was referred to the BIFR.

In the absence of any tangible revival plan, the company was identified for liquidation in 2008-09. By that time, Coal India Limited had recognised the need to revive underground mining, since the depths of opencast mines were increasing, in some cases to alarming levels of 200 metres or even more. With over 80 billion tonnes of coal resources occurring at depths beyond 300 metres, amenable to gainful extraction only through mechanised underground mining, the need for a vibrant domestic capability to manufacture underground mining equipment became apparent. As Chairman of CIL, I considered it prudent to join hands with existing mining equipment manufacturers as well as consumers of mining equipment for their operations to take over the assets of MAMC, for which bids were invited by the Liquidator. A

loose consortium of three companies, namely CIL, BEML, and DVC, was formed to participate in the bidding. As the equipment manufacturer, BEML was given the lead role, with a 48% equity share, while the balance was allotted to CIL and DVC at 26% each.

Fortunately, the bid submitted by the consortium turned out to be the highest. This enabled the retention of the vast tract of land for the manufacturing industry instead of it being diverted to other purposes, with real estate being the dominant claimant. The outcome became known in 2010.

In 2010-11, CIL floated its maiden IPO. As Chairman, I was totally engrossed and had to put in all-out efforts to make the IPO a resounding success. As a result, the MAMC matter was largely left in the hands of BEML, the majority partner. In February 2011, I superannuated from CIL.

Thereafter, for various reasons, I lost track of, as well as interest in,

the matter. With the new government being sworn in in Bengal, I thought it meaningful to bring the matter into the public domain. To the best of my knowledge and belief, the land parcel should still be available for building industry relevant to current times. Taking stock of the current ownership of the land from records that may be in the possession of BEML could form the starting point. Securing possession of the land may require a few rounds of communication between the concerned departments of the Government of West Bengal, the Ministry of Heavy Industries, Government of India, and BEML. Once possession is established, the use of the land for setting up industries, including but not limited to the manufacture of mining equipment, coal gasification, solar panels, data centres, etc., can be decided through deliberation and discourse.

Views expressed are personal

POWER EQUATIONS



BAGMITA BORTHAKUR

THE WRITER IS A PHD RESEARCH SCHOLAR, BITS PILANI

Representation becomes meaningful only when women are judged by governance, not by gender or political convenience

Double Standards of Women's Representation

As India expands women's political representation through constitutional reform, the true test of democracy lies in whether women leaders receive the same legitimacy, scrutiny and political space as men

There is an enduring paradox at the heart of democratic politics. Few political ideals command the near-universal consensus that women's empowerment does. Yet, that consensus has an uncanny tendency to dissolve the moment empowerment ceases to be an abstraction and assumes the form of a woman wielding political authority.

"Women's empowerment" appears with comforting regularity in political manifestos, parliamentary speeches, and government campaigns. It is invoked across ideological divides with such frequency that it has acquired the quality of an unquestionable civic virtue, a principle so self-evidently desirable that no political formation can publicly dissent from it. Yet current practice has exposed the gap between what is professed and what is practised.

India has simultaneously embarked on a broader constitutional project to increase women's participation in politics. The passage of the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam represented an acknowledgement that political exclusion is not merely a statistical imbalance but a democratic deficit. The legislation sought to correct a historic asymmetry in representation, with the belief that increasing the presence of women in legislatures would gradually alter the grammar of political power itself. It provides for reserving one-third of the seats in the Lok Sabha and state legislative assemblies for women after the delimitation process.

Yet representation is meaningful only when accompanied by legitimacy. It is inconsistent to celebrate women's entry into politics in principle while refus-



Empowerment cannot remain a slogan when women seek real political authority

ing to accord women leaders the same presumption of competence routinely extended to their male counterparts.

It is against this broader democratic backdrop that the debate surrounding Maharashtra's first woman Deputy Chief Minister ought to be understood. Regardless of political affiliation, the appointment of Sunetra Pawar as the state's first woman Deputy Chief Minister marks a historic milestone. Maharashtra, a state with a rich legacy of social reform and women's education inspired by pioneers such as Savitribai Phule and Mahatma Jyotirao Phule, has taken an unprecedented step in elevating a woman to one of its highest executive offices.

Women in politics have historically encountered a lower threshold for acceptance. Their decisions are often personalised, their authority questioned more readily, and their political legitimacy subjected to standards that male leaders rarely face. Such asymmetry weakens the larger project of democratic inclusion.

This is not to suggest that women lead-

ers should be insulated from scrutiny. Democratic office demands scrutiny, accountability, and disagreement, irrespective of gender. To argue otherwise would itself constitute a form of paternalism, reducing women to political beneficiaries rather than constitutional equals. But equality requires consistency. The standards by which we evaluate leadership cannot fluctuate according to the identity of the leader or the political convenience of the observer. A commitment to women's empowerment that survives only so long as women remain rhetorical symbols but weakens once they become political actors is not a commitment to equality at all. It is merely an attachment to its language.

The debate surrounding Sunetra Pawar's appointment illustrates this tension. Critics are entitled to evaluate her decisions and hold her government accountable, but criticism should not turn into personal attacks or premature conclusions about her ability to lead. Before assuming the office of Deputy Chief

Minister, Pawar served as a nominated member of Parliament in the Rajya Sabha, where she raised 126 questions, well above the reported average of 92, reflecting sustained parliamentary engagement.

The broader political conversation also deserves consistency. Several opposition leaders have been vocal advocates of increasing women's representation in legislatures and have supported the faster implementation of the women's reservation framework. Their advocacy carries greater credibility when it is matched by equal respect for women who attain positions of executive leadership, irrespective of the party to which they belong. The principle of representation cannot be selective; otherwise, it becomes merely a slogan rather than a conviction.

Leaders like Supriya Sule and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra have repeatedly advocated greater representation for women. Yet the same opposition often resorts to selective targeting instead of extending support.

Democratic accountability demands that every

minister be evaluated and judged rigorously, but the appropriate yardstick is governance, administrative competence, legislative performance, policy outcomes, and public service. In Sunetra Pawar's case, those assessments should emerge over time as her tenure unfolds rather than from assumptions formed before her record can be fairly evaluated.

It inevitably invites a larger question: Can political parties simultaneously celebrate women's representation in principle while withholding from individual women the political space to be judged on the substance of their governance rather than the symbolism of their appointment?

This is where democracies often reveal their deepest inconsistencies. They do not fail because they lack progressive legislation; they falter because they fail to cultivate political cultures capable of sustaining the values that legislation seeks to institutionalise. Constitutional amendments can redistribute opportunities. They cannot, by themselves, dismantle the assumptions that continue to shape how authority is perceived when exercised by women.

If political parties genuinely believe that India needs more women in positions of power, then that commitment must extend beyond legislative reform. It must also be reflected in how women who already occupy those offices are treated. Empowerment cannot be contingent on a party's affiliation, nor can equality be selective.

Democracies mature when principles are applied consistently, not conveniently. Women's representation deserves exactly that consistency.

Views expressed are personal

NO TSUNAMI DETECTED

Magnitude 7.1 quake shakes part of Japan

TOKYO: An earthquake registering a magnitude of 7.1 shook Kumamoto on Japan's southern main island of Kyushu late Tuesday afternoon, causing damage and injuries, officials said.

The second floor at the Aeon Mall shopping centre in Kashima Town collapsed, trapping an unknown number of people. Rescue operations were being carried out, the Fire and Disaster Management Agency said without giving further details.

There was a report of an explosion before the collapse at the centre, Kyodo News Agency reported.

A tsunami advisory for the nearby Ariake and Yatsushiro Seas on the western coasts of Kumamoto and three neighbouring prefectures was temporarily issued but was lifted within two hours, the Japan Meteorological Agency said. The area is about 900 kilometres southwest of Tokyo.

The US Geological Survey initially said the earthquake had a magnitude of 7.1, but revised it later to 6.8.

Japan's Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi, in a message posted on X, said her government has set up a task force



An aerial image shows part of a bridge that collapsed after the earthquake in Yatsushiro on Tuesday

to gather information, assess possible damage and prepare for rescue operations if needed.

Takaichi later told reporters that there have been reports of a number of injuries and



An aerial image shows the damaged AEON Mall after an earthquake in Kashima on Tuesday

Highlights

- » There was a report of an explosion before the collapse at the centre
- » The US Geological Survey initially said the earthquake had a magnitude of 7.1, but revised it later to 6.8
- » Local fire departments received many emergency calls reporting fires and damage to homes

damages to roads, bridges and buildings, as well as blackouts and fire, though details are still unclear. Takaichi warned people cooking to be careful with fire and with shards of broken glass.

Kyodo News Agency said a hospital in Yatsushiro city accepted about 40 people with injuries from the quake. A train was derailed and fell on its side at the Yatsushiro station, and stone walls were

damaged at the Kumamoto castle, Kyodo said.

Yojo Kai, a priest at a Shinto shrine in the nearby town of Mashiki, said a few stone lanterns fell down. "I worried if the main hall and the gate would

tilt again," he told Kyodo.

"The shaking reminded me of the Kumamoto quake (10 years ago) and I was frightened," said Hiroki Shimoda, an official at the Mifune town hall, who saw rooftiles of nearby homes crash down to the ground.

Japan's Fire and Disaster Management Agency said there were no reports of damage to major public facilities and infrastructure, though authorities were still assessing the extent of damage. Local fire departments received many emergency calls reporting fires and damage to homes.

"We are putting people's lives as the top priority," Takaichi said, urging residents in the strongly shaken areas to use caution in light of possible aftershocks.

Shinji Kiyomoto, JMA's Earthquake and Tsunami Countermeasures planning officer, told a news conference that the shallow earthquake was triggering active seismic activity in the area, urging residents to especially be cautious over the next two to three days. He said, however, that no tsunami was observed from the inland quake.

Lindsey Graham eulogized as an 'American original' at services in Washington



WASHINGTON: Sen. Lindsey Graham, the son of pool hall owners who rose to become one of his generation's more influential US politicians at home and abroad, is being eulogized Tuesday as a "swashbuckling" public servant and "true American original" during memorial services in Washington.

Graham's flag-draped casket arrived for a tribute at the US Capitol, where the Republican served for more than 30 years as an indefatigable dealmaker who talked and laughed and badgered his colleagues into action. Later, the motorcade departed for a funeral at

Washington National Cathedral with President Donald Trump and foreign leaders, a testament to his stature on the global stage.

"Lindsey was a towering figure," said Senate Majority Leader John Thune, adding there was "no one more capable of cracking up a room."

"I look forward to the days when you make us all laugh again," said Thune, R-S.D., choking back tears.

Trump is expected to deliver remarks in the afternoon at the cathedral, alongside Fox News Channel's Sean Hannity and other conservative leaders.

Uganda declares itself free of Ebola outbreak

KAMPALA: Ugandan authorities said on Tuesday the East African country is "free" of Ebola after the last patient was discharged in mid-June, a delicate milestone as the virus continues to plague a remote part of neighbouring Congo.

Uganda always insisted its outbreak was linked to the larger one that started in eastern Congo's province of Ituri, which shares a land border with Uganda.

According to local authorities, the first cases in Uganda's outbreak were Con-

golese people who crossed the border to seek treatment for an unknown illness before it was known they had Ebola.

Congo declared its outbreak on May 15, the same day Uganda confirmed two Ebola cases — including a man who had already died.

"Unlike previous Ebola outbreaks that informed the current 42-day declaration policy, Uganda's 2026 Ebola outbreak arose from a fully documented importation event," the Ugandan Ministry of Health said in a statement Tuesday.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023) Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Shankar S/o Lt. Shrawan Kumar R/o H.No. R-560, Mangol Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1013/2020 Dt. 04.12.2020 U/s 12/9/55 G. Act at P.S.: Mangol Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Shankar** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shankar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Shankar** of case **FIR No. 1013/2020 Dt. 04.12.2020 U/s 12/9/55 G Act of P.S.: Mangol Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.

By order
Reetika Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
North West Court No.105,
Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Surender Singh S/o Sadhu Singh R/o I-477, Mangol Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 837/2014 U/S 392/34 IPC, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Surender Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Surender Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Surender Singh** of **FIR No. 837/2014 U/S 392/34 IPC, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **16.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (West)
Room No. 356, 3rd Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc/84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Gambhir Singh S/o Ganga Singh R/o K-6/1, Vijay Vihar, Phase 1, Sector-4, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 380/2018 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Gambhir Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gambhir Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gambhir Singh** of **FIR No. 380/2018 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **30.11.2026 at 10:00 am**.

By Order,
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
North West District, Room No. 109, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10196/RD/2026(Court Matter)

PoK polls: Sharif's PML-N wins nine seats out of 13 in first phase

ISLAMABAD: The Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N) won nine out of 13 seats in the first phase of elections held in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, the Election Commission said on Tuesday.

There were allegations of massive rigging in the first phase of the polls held on Monday, in which the Pakistan's People Party (PPP) won the remaining seats.

The elections for 45 contesting seats in the so-called legislative assembly in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) are happening in three phases between July 27 and August 10 amid widespread violence.

India maintains that the entire Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh are integral and inalienable parts of it. New Delhi also asserts that Pakistan has been in "illegal and forcible occupation" of parts of these Union Territories.

On Tuesday, India described the ongoing elections in PoK as an attempt by Islamabad to camouflage its illegal occupation and hide its



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

New Delhi also asserts that Pakistan has been in 'illegal and forcible occupation' of parts of these Union Territories

"grave" human rights violations in the region. "The current cosmetic electoral exercise is nothing but an attempt by Pakistan to camouflage its illegal occupation and hide its grave human rights violations in the region," External

Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said in New Delhi.

According to preliminary results issued by the PoK Election Commission on Tuesday, the PML-N led by the Sharif brothers - Nawaz and Shehbaz - emerged as the winner in nine constituencies while the PPP led by the Bhuttos secured four seats.

Both parties are coalition partners in the federal government.

It is a direct contest between the two in PoK because former prime minister Imran Khan's party Pakistan Tehreek-i-Insaf has boycotted the polls.

NORTHERN RAILWAY E-AUCTION NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for allotment of contracts of Water Vending Machines (WVMs) and Multi Purpose Stalls (MPS) at following railway stations/locations:

Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Cluster No.	No. of WVMs at Railway Stations
CTG-WVM-06-2026	10.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs	I	Total 06 WVMs (01 WVM at Garhi Harsaru, 01 WVM at Patli, 01 WVM at Pataudi Road, 01 WVM at Palam, 02 WVMs at Delhi Sarai Rohilla Railway Station).
		J	Total 10 WVMs (04 WVMs at Meerut City, 02 WVMs at Modinagar, 01 WVM at Vivek Vihar, 03 WVMs at Delhi Shahdara Railway Station).
		H	Total 09 WVMs (02 WVMs at Jind, 02 WVMs at Narwana, 02 WVMs at Tohana, 02 WVMs at Jakhla, 01 WVM at Mansa Railway Station).
		A	Total 10 WVMs (01 WVM at Baraut, 01 WVM at Baghpat Road, 01 WVM at Noli, 02 WVMs at Sharni, 01 WVM at Rampur Maniharan and 04 WVMs at Muzaffarnagar Railway Station).
		K	Total 09 WVMs (01 WVM at Okhla, 01 WVM at Tuglakabad, 01 WVM at Faridabad, 01 WVM at Faridabad New Town, 02 WVMs at Ballabh Garh and 03 WVMs at Palwal Railway Station).
Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Railway Station	Lot No.
MPS-JULY-02-26	10.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs	DEE	MPS-DLI-DEE-MPS-163-25-2, MPS-DLI-DEE-MPS-131-25-2
		NZM	MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-113-25-2, MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-116-25-2, MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-122-25-1, MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-156-25-1, MPS-DLI-NZM-MPS-126-25-2
		KUN	MPS-DLI-KUN-MPS-135-25-2
		MDNR	MPS-DLI-MDNR-MPS-147-25-2
		MTC	MPS-DLI-MTC-MPS-140-25-1, MPS-DLI-MTC-MPS-141-25-1

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://ireps.gov.in/> (E-Auction-Leasing)

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- » Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module – Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module.
- » Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details.
- » A new mechanism namely **Virtual Account Number (VAN)** has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.
- » The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- » Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender / E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to Contact, in case of any query)	Divisional Railway Manager's Office Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi – 110055, Email: catering.delhidivision@gmail.com, Tel: 011-23743084
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No. 23 AC/Ctg./e-Auction/WVM & MPS/2026 Date: 00.07.2026 2598/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

BOTH HELD A CLOSED-DOOR MEETING

Trump, Netanyahu meet for the 1st time since launching Iran war

WASHINGTON: Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and President Donald Trump met at the White House on Tuesday for the first time since they launched a joint war against Iran, offering a chance for Netanyahu to smooth out strains in their relationship.

The closed-door meeting lasted nearly an hour and a half and was "positive and productive," according to White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt. The White House and prime minister's office did not immediately offer more details.

It comes as both face growing pressures at home. Netanyahu is up for reelection and is embattled in part because of his deteriorating relationship with Trump. Trump is under pressure to end an unpopular war that has wreaked economic havoc and driven prices higher ahead of midterm elections this November.

Trump revealed some tension with Netanyahu ahead of their meeting, complaining



Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu with US President Donald Trump

about reports that the Israeli leader plans to discuss intelligence on Iranian activities at Pickaxe Mountain, a potential nuclear site that the US president has threatened repeatedly to bomb.

"I know exactly what's going on at Pickaxe," Trump told "Fox & Friends." He insisted that whatever Iran is doing is "not a big problem" and that "Bibi's telling me that because

he wants me to stay involved." "Why do you have to announce to the world?" Trump added, flashing his frustrations with his ally.

Near the White House where the public was able to gather near fencing, a small group of protesters chanted, "Netanyahu, you're a tyrant" and "Bibi, you're not welcome here," referencing the prime minister's nickname.

Chad to quit from ICC

DAKAR: Chad announced plans Monday to withdraw from the International Criminal Court, accusing the judicial body of ineffectiveness and bias against African countries.

The West African country submitted a letter to the United Nations to begin withdrawing from the court, which was established to prosecute people responsible for humanity's worst crimes under its foundational treaty, the Rome Statute.

The withdrawal process takes at least a year.

Chad was the fourth African country since 2025 to begin withdrawing from the ICC.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi S/o Rajpal R/o House No. 95A, Gali No. 7, Dheeraj Vihar, Karala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 02/2019 U/S 457/380/411 IPC, PS Begampur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Ravi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ravi** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ravi** of **FIR No. 02/2019 U/S 457/380/411 IPC, PS Begampur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **01.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West District, Court No. 101, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10243/RD/2026(Court Matter)

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE (As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.** (MHIL) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon. The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Aarti/ Bharat/ Dev/ 083-08300434/ Delhi	Description of The Property Entire Second Floor Portion, Bearing Pvt. No. 06, Without Roof Rights, Area Measuring 75 Sq. Yard, or 62.70 Sq. Mtr. Built on Khalsa No. 123/18 Min, Within Extended Lal Abadi of Village Burari, Sant Nagar, Burari, New Delhi 110084. (Hereinafter Called The Said Flat) 5. Flat Bounded As Under: East: Road West: Other's Property North: Krishna Apartment South: Other's Property	24-Apr-2026/- Rs. 20,49,666/- Rupees Twenty Lakh Forty Nine Thousand Six Hundred Sixty Six Only.	27-Jul-2026

Date: July 29, 2026, Place: Sant Nagar

Sd/- Authorized Officer, Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

TO BOOST INTERNATIONAL AIR CONNECTIVITY

Govt plans 44 airports under Hub & Spoke flight model

OUR CORRESPONDENT

AMRITSAR: The government aims to have a total of 44 airports, including 4 hub airports, to provide seamless international air connectivity, a senior government official said on Tuesday.

Air India on Tuesday launched flight service under the Hub and Spoke model from Amritsar, the second airport after Varanasi from where such flights have been started.

Presently, there is one hub airport — Delhi — and two spoke airports — Varanasi and Amritsar. The next spoke airport will be Ahmedabad.

The model, that seeks to make India a global aviation hub, will enable seamless connectivity between Tier-II and Tier-III airports with international destinations through hub airports.

Passengers arriving from smaller cities will be routed through major hub airports such as Delhi for onward international connections.

At a function at the Amritsar airport to mark the launch of Hub and Spoke model flights, Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha said 4 hubs and 40 airports would be developed.

From Amritsar, Air India will connect to 27 international destinations through Delhi under the model.



Air India on Tuesday launched flights under the Hub and Spoke model from Amritsar, the second airport after Varanasi from where such fights have been started

In a video message, Civil Aviation Minister K Rammo-han Naidu said Hub and Spoke is an "aviation sovereignty" and an "opportunity" model for India.

The government aims to develop 100 airports and 200 heliports in 10 years, the minister said.

Under the model, Air India has introduced 'Easy Connect' flights that will enable travellers from cities beyond major hubs to drop baggage and complete immigration at the origin air-

port and travel seamlessly to overseas destinations.

From Amritsar, Air India will have 'Easy Connect' flights to 27 overseas destinations within four hours of arrival in Delhi, including to cities in the US, Canada, UK, Europe, Australia, West Asia, and Southeast Asia, the airline said.

Air India will have two daily 'Easy Connect' flights from Amritsar starting on Tuesday.

"As part of the 'Easy Connect' programme, international travellers from Amritsar can

HIGHLIGHTS

» Presently, there is one hub airport — Delhi — two spoke airports — Varanasi and Amritsar. The next spoke airport will be Ahmedabad

» The model will enable seamless connectivity between Tier-II and Tier-III airports with international destinations through hub airports

» At a function at Amritsar airport to mark the launch of Hub & Spoke model flights, Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha said 4 hubs & 40 airports would be developed

complete through check-in to their final destinations, clear immigration formalities at Amritsar airport, and enjoy seamless transfers through Delhi without having to re-check baggage or change terminals," the airline said in a release.

In the coming weeks, Air India will start such flights from Ahmedabad, Goa, Kochi, and other Indian cities.

The first 'Easy Connect' service was launched from Varanasi on June 25.

Urea imports rise 83% to 103.5 lakh tonnes in last financial year

NEW DELHI: India's urea imports jumped 83 per cent last fiscal to 103.50 lakh tonnes to meet rising domestic demand, according to government data.

In a written reply to the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday, Minister of State for Chemicals and Fertilizers Anupriya Patel shared production and imports of major fertilizers during the last five fiscal years.

As per the data, the urea imports increased to 103.50 lakh tonnes in 2025-26 fiscal from 56.47 lakh tonnes in the preceding year.

In the 2020-21 fiscal, urea imports stood at 91.36 lakh tonnes, while imports were 75.80 lakh tonnes in 2022-23 and 70.42 lakh tonnes in 2023-24.

Further, the imports of di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) also rose to 61.94 lakh tonnes last fiscal from 45.69 lakh tonnes in 2024-25.

The imports of DAP stood at 54.62 lakh tonnes in 2020-21, 65.83 lakh tonnes in 2021-22 fiscal and 55.67 lakh tonnes in 2022-23.

Urea production fell to 293.26 lakh tonnes in 2025-26 from 306.67 lakh tonnes in the preceding year. However, the DAP output rose to 39.14 lakh tonnes last fiscal from 37.72 lakh tonnes in 2024-25. India's total fertiliser production stood at 517.49 lakh tonnes during 2025-26. **PTI**

India's cities need \$2.4 trillion by 2050, municipal corporations raise fraction of that: FICCI-EY

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's cities would need an estimated \$2.4 trillion in investment by 2050 to become climate-resilient and low-carbon, yet only twenty municipal corporations had ever accessed the capital markets, together raising close to \$476 million, according to a report titled Cities as Growth Engines: Powering India's Next Leap, released jointly by FICCI and EY (Ernst & Young) on Tuesday.

The report cited over 8,000 Smart Cities Mission projects worth more than Rs 1.64 lakh crore, Rs 2.7 lakh crore committed under AMRUT, and 1.25 crore houses sanctioned under PMAY-Urban as the delivery record underpinning its recommendations.

The report noted that urban

areas contributed more than 60 per cent of national GDP from about a third of the population, while municipal corporations collectively raised revenues equivalent to just 0.6 per cent of GDP.

India's urban infrastructure requirement was pegged at nearly \$840 billion over the next fifteen years, or roughly \$55 billion a year, with nearly 70 per cent of the urban infrastructure needed by 2047 yet to be built.

Urban India was projected to house nearly 600 million people by 2036, contributing almost 70 per cent of GDP, rising to 877 million people and 75 per cent of GDP by 2050.

The report cited the Union Cabinet's Rs 1,00,000 crore Urban Challenge Fund, which requires urban local bodies to mobilise half of every proj-

ect's cost from capital markets, as a signal that Indian cities must be structured to be financeable.

Six strategic shifts were proposed, including moving from service delivery to economic leadership, from concentrated growth to a network of growth cities, and from climate vulnerability to climate resilience, with Tier-II and Tier-III cities positioned as regional growth hubs.

Chairman of the FICCI Committee on Urban Development and Real Estate, Raj Menda, said India's next phase of urban development must move beyond infrastructure creation to building economically competitive, investment-ready cities, adding that governance, innovative financing and integrated planning would be critical to advancing Viksit Bharat 2047.

The report has mentioned

'Made in Bharat' chips for space rockets soon: Ashwini Vaishnaw

NEW DELHI: India will soon equip its space launch vehicles with domestically produced semiconductors, according to Union Minister for Electronics and IT Ashwini Vaishnaw.

On Monday, meeting the heads of private space technology company Skyroot Aerospace, after its Vikram-1 Test Flight-1 successfully reached orbit, marking the maiden flight of India's first privately developed orbital-class rocket, Vaishnaw said on X, "Made in Bharat" chips for our rockets... soon!"

Replying to the post by the Union Minister on X, Skyroot acknowledged the government support and stated, "Honoured to meet Hon'ble Union Minister Shri @AshwiniVaishnaw. India's deep-tech ecosystem is accelerating -- powered by forward-looking reforms, world-class digital infrastructure, and a strong commitment to innovation."

The company further expressed its commitment to domestic hardware integration, stating, "Skyroot is proud to contribute by building globally competitive space technology from India. We look forward to the day India-built chips fly on our rockets."

Earlier, Prime Minister Narendra Modi also had a "great interaction" with Skyroot Aerospace founders Pawan Chandana and Naga Bharath Daka and discussed the success of the Vikram-1 mission and the future of India's private space sector.

In a post on X, Modi said he had a "great interaction" with



Union Minister for Electronics and IT Ashwini Vaishnaw

'India's deep-tech ecosystem is accelerating on forward-looking reforms, world-class digital infra and a strong commitment to innovation'

Chandana and Daka, adding that the "success of Vikram-1 naturally featured prominently" in their discussion.

"A great interaction with

Pawan Chandana and Naga Bharath Daka of Skyroot Aerospace. The success of Vikram-1 naturally featured prominently in our discussion, in addition to many other interesting subjects. Happy to hear about their journey so far and their insights on what lies ahead. Their energy, ambition and positivity reflect the vibrant spirit of our private space ecosystem. Best wishes

to the entire Skyroot team," PM Modi wrote on X.

Skyroot Aerospace also posted about the meeting on X, saying its founders had the privilege of sharing the company's journey, Vikram-1's successful mission and its vision for the future of space with PM Modi.

"An honour to meet Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri @narendramodi. Our founders, Pawan Chandana and Naga Bharath Daka, had the privilege of sharing Skyroot's journey, Vikram-1's successful mission, and our vision for the future of space," he wrote on X.

On July 18, Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 Test Flight-1 successfully reached orbit, marking the maiden flight of India's first privately developed orbital-class rocket. The rocket completed its final burn and injected its payloads into a nearly 450-km orbit, making India the third country in the world with private orbital launch capability. **ANI**

Rupee rises 17 paise to 95.82 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee stayed on an upward track for the third straight session and ended 17 paise higher at 95.82 against the US dollar on Tuesday, supported by lower crude oil prices amid signals of easing West Asia crisis.

According to forex traders, the sustained outflow of foreign capital amid selling pressure in domestic equity markets, as well as an elevated dollar index ahead of the US Federal Reserve's policy decision, capped gains for the local currency.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.75 and touched the intraday high of 95.63.

The local unit finally settled at 95.82 against the dollar, up 17 paise compared to its previous closing level.

On Monday, the rupee appreciated sharply by 54 paise to close at 95.99 against the US dollar, after rising 20 paise in the preceding session on Friday.

Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said the rupee strengthened on the halting of strikes between the US and Iran.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading 0.08 per cent higher at 101.46. **PTI**

Markets end flat amid heavy selloff in Asian markets, Sensex falls 70 pts

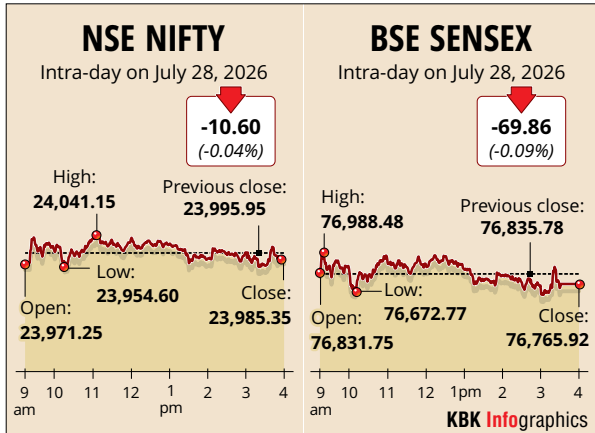
MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended flat on Tuesday as investors' sentiment turned cautious ahead of key global central bank policy meetings this week and heavy selloff across Asian markets.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dipped 69.86 points, or 0.09 per cent, to settle at 76,765.92.

The 50-share NSE Nifty slipped 10.60 points, or 0.04 per cent, to end at 23,985.35.

From the Sensex pack, Hindustan Unilever tanked 6.97 per cent, followed by Bharat Electronics, NTPC, ICICI Bank, Power Grid, and Reliance Industries were also among the laggards. TCS, Eternal, Tech Mahindra, Infosys, and Titan were among the major gainers.

The BSE SmallCap Select index dipped 0.21 per cent, while MidCap Select index went up 0.35 per cent.



Among sectors, capital goods dropped 2.40 per cent, power (2.36 per cent), utilities (1.75 per cent), FMCG (1.27 per cent), industrials (1.22 per cent), energy (0.68 per cent) and commodities (0.68 per cent). Focused IT jumped 3.44 per

cent, IT (3.05 per cent), realty (2.19 per cent), consumer durables (1.32 per cent), auto (0.71 per cent) and consumer discretionary (0.62 per cent). A total of 2,629 stocks declined, 1,626 advanced & 169 remained unchanged on the BSE. **PTI**

J&J to pay \$5.5 bn to settle 76K talc cancer cases

NEW YORK: Johnson & Johnson (J&J) has agreed to pay an estimated \$5.5 billion to settle about 76,000 lawsuits alleging its baby powder and other talc-based products caused ovarian cancer, marking a major step toward ending a decade-long legal battle.

The settlement covers nearly all remaining ovarian cancer claims against the company in federal and state courts.

It will become effective only if 95 per cent of claimants approve the agreement. J&J had previously resolved most lawsuits alleging its talc products contained asbestos and caused mesothelioma.

Despite the settlement, J&J reiterated that the claims lack merit. Erik Haas, the company's vice president of litigation, said

Plaintiffs' attorney Chris Seeger, said the total payout could exceed \$7 billion because settlement does not cap compensation if more eligible claims qualify

the company remained confident it would have prevailed in court but chose to settle to bring closure and focus on its core healthcare business.

Under the agreement, J&J expects to pay \$3 billion in 2027, with additional payments in 2028.

However, plaintiffs' attorney Chris Seeger, who helped negotiate the deal, said the total payout could exceed \$7 billion because the settlement does not cap compensation if more eligible claims qualify.

The agreement follows a series of legal victories for J&J, including favourable trial outcomes, court rulings excluding key expert testimony and a recent federal court decision that questioned plaintiffs' ability to prove talc specifically caused ovarian cancer.

J&J has consistently denied that its talc products caused cancer or contained asbestos. The company stopped selling talc-based baby powder in the US in 2020, replacing it with a cornstarch-based version.

The litigation resumed in

March 2025 after courts dismissed J&J's three attempts to resolve the claims through the controversial "Texas two-step" bankruptcy strategy involving a subsidiary.

Before those efforts, the company had faced mixed courtroom results, including a multibillion-dollar verdict in favour of 22 women, while winning or overturning several other cases.

Unlike the failed bankruptcy proposals, the new settlement applies only to existing claims and excludes future lawsuits.

Plaintiffs' lawyers said this allows current claimants to receive larger payouts, with all payments expected to be completed within about 18 months instead of over a decade. **AGENCIES**

Coal India's capex rises 16.64% to ₹3,399 cr in June quarter of FY27

The company also surpassed its quarterly capex target of Rs 3,349 crore, achieving 101.5% of planned expenditure

KOLKATA: Coal India Ltd (CIL) recorded a capital expenditure (capex) of Rs 3,399 crore during Q1 FY27, registering a growth of 16.64 per cent over the Rs 2,914 crore incurred during the corresponding period of the previous financial year.

The company also surpassed its quarterly capex target of Rs 3,349 crore, achieving 101.5 per cent of the planned expenditure. The company's Q1 spending represents 20.60 per cent of CIL's total capex target of Rs 16,500 crore for the current fiscal.

Land acquisition and related rehabilitation & resettlement



activities accounted for the highest expenditure in Q1 FY27 at Rs 804 crore, constituting nearly one-fourth of the total capex. Land acquisition & related activities have been allocated the highest capex target of Rs 4,173 crore out of CIL's total annual capex target for FY27.

CLOSER LOOK

» The company's spending in Q1 FY27 represents 20.60% of CIL's total capex target of Rs 16,500 crore for FY27

» Land acquisition & related rehabilitation & resettlement activities accounted for highest expenditure in Q1 at Rs 804 crore, constituting nearly one-fourth of total capex

Coal India also continued to strengthen its coal evacuation infrastructure by investing Rs 754 crore in the development of railway sidings and rail corridors. In addition, Rs 195 crore was spent on the construction of coal handling plants (CHPs), silos, weighbridges and roads,

taking the cumulative expenditure on coal evacuation infrastructure to Rs 949 crore during the quarter ended June 2026.

Capex under the Plant & Machinery (P&M) segment stood at Rs 819 crore, covering procurement of Heavy Earth Moving Machinery (HEMM),

construction and expansion of washeries, and other plant and equipment-related activities. This category also accounted for nearly one-fourth of the company's total capex during the quarter.

"Expenditures on land acquisition, development of coal evacuation infrastructure, and plant & machinery constitute the major components of our capital expenditure. Together, these three broad heads accounted for over 75 per cent of the total capex incurred during the first quarter," said B Sairam, Chairman, Coal India. Coal India incurred a capi-

tal expenditure of Rs 278 crore on its solar projects during the quarter, while investments in the company's joint ventures (JVs) amounted to Rs 207 crore, reinforcing its commitment to expanding its presence in renewable energy and allied businesses.

Notably, CIL had achieved a capex of Rs 19,607 crore during FY26, surpassing its annual target of Rs 16,000 crore, reflecting the company's sustained focus on strengthening mining infrastructure, enhancing coal evacuation capabilities and advancing its clean energy initiatives. **MPOST**

Gold falls by ₹2,640, silver slides to ₹2,24,800/kg

NEW DELHI: Gold prices fell by Rs 2,640 to Rs 1.47 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, and silver dropped by Rs 5,200, on weak global trends and firm rupee.

The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity depreciated by Rs 2,640 to Rs 1,47,000 per 10 grams from Monday's closing level of Rs 1,49,640 per 10 grams, according to the All India Sarafa Association.

Silver also witnessed selling and tumbled Rs 5,200 to Rs 2,24,800 per kilogram. The white metal had settled at Rs 2,30,000 per kg in the previous session.

Traders said a stronger



rupee reduced the landed cost of imported bullion in the domestic market, while weak global trends and caution ahead of the US Federal Reserve's policy decision kept investors' sentiment subdued.

In the global markets, spot gold fell \$53.30, or 1.31 per cent, to \$4,023.50 per ounce and silver dropped 2 per cent to \$57.24 per ounce. **PTI**

‘India plans up to quarter of 2027 LPG imports from US’

India faced worst LPG shortage earlier this year after the Iran war, closure of Strait of Hormuz disrupted supplies

NEW DELHI: India plans to buy up to a quarter of its liquefied petroleum gas imports from the US in 2027, a move that would cut its reliance on the Middle East and support efforts to secure a trade deal with Washington, three sources with knowledge of the matter said.

New Delhi faced its worst LPG shortage earlier this year after the Iran war and closure of the Strait of Hormuz disrupted supplies. The government invoked emergency measures to divert petrochemical feedstocks from industry to households, which use LPG as cooking gas, *Reuters* reported.

The world's third-biggest oil importer and consumer bought about 90 per cent of its overall 21.85 million metric tons of LPG imports from the Middle East in 2025. Imports accounted for about 66 per cent of India's LPG consumption, according to government data.

State refiners Indian Oil Corp (IOC), Bharat Petroleum Corp (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum (HPCL) are expected to issue tenders within one to two months for US LPG



supplies in 2027, the sources said, adding a delegation from the companies is also likely to travel to the US next month to discuss sourcing. Higher US energy purchases could help India narrow its trade surplus with Washington, a key demand from President Donald Trump, as New Delhi pushes to complete a long-awaited trade deal with Washington in the next three to four months.

India has pledged to increase US energy purchases by \$10 billion to \$25 billion in the near future, and the two nations have agreed to target \$500 billion in bilateral

trade by 2030. New Delhi has already accelerated spot purchases from the US and other suppliers to offset reduced Middle East supplies. US LPG imports topped 1 million tons in June for the first time and are likely to exceed India's initial 2026 annual-contract target of 2.2 million tons, the sources said.

Lower supplies from the Middle East curtailed India's LPG consumption to about 14.7 million tons in January-June 2026, down about 8 per cent from a year earlier, while imports fell about 28 per cent to about 7.5 million tons, pro-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Imports accounted for about 66 per cent of India's LPG consumption, according to government data
- » State refiners IOC, BPCL & HPCL are expected to issue tenders within one to two months for US LPG supplies in 2027, the sources said

visional government data showed.

This year India's LPG consumption is expected to decline to 30 million tons due to low supplies, one of the sources said.

But LPG imports could rise to about 20 million tons in 2027 as demand recovers to around 31 million tons, the source said.

"Diversification of LPG imports is being pursued to ensure supply security and mitigate risks arising from regional disruptions or geopolitical events," junior oil minister Suresh Gopi told lawmakers on Monday. AGENCIES

Infra projects register cost overrun of around ₹4,92,752 crore, says MoSPI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Infrastructure projects worth above Rs 150 crore each registered a cumulative cost overrun of around Rs 4,92,752 crore, according to a monthly government report for June 2026.

A total of 1,847 ongoing infrastructure projects across 17 Central Ministries/ Departments were monitored and it was found that the total revised cost was Rs 40,54,473 crore compared to their original cost of Rs 35,61,721 crore.

The report, however, did not specify the actual number of projects that faced cost overrun.

The cumulative expenditure incurred on these projects stands at Rs 21.97 lakh crore, accounting for approximately 54.18 per cent of the revised project cost, indicating steady progress in project implementation, a statement by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) said.

A significant proportion of projects are at advanced stages, with 709 projects (39 per cent) achieving over 80 per cent physical progress, while 337 (19 per cent) have crossed 80 per cent financial completion. The data also showed a balanced pipeline, with projects distributed across early and advanced stages of implementation.

The Transport & Logistics sector accounts for the highest



number of ongoing projects (1341 projects), with revised estimates of Rs 22.32 lakh crore underscoring priority to connectivity-driven infrastructure growth.

The 1,847 ongoing infrastructure projects include 769 Mega projects (project cost of Rs 1,000 crore & above) with an original cost of Rs 30.51 lakh crore, and 1,078 Major projects (project cost below Rs 1,000 crore and up to Rs 150 crore) amounting to Rs 5.10 lakh crore.

Physical and financial progress broadly move in tandem, with a large number of projects clustered at the initial (0-20 per cent) and advanced (81-100 per cent) stages, indicating a pipeline of newly-started projects alongside many nearing completion.

While physical progress exceeds financial progress in the 81-100 per cent range, financial progress is relatively higher in the early stages, reflecting upfront expenditure patterns in project implementation.

Ministry of Road Transport & Highways accounts for the

highest number of projects, with 1022 projects (55 per cent), and a share of total revised project cost of Rs 9.89 lakh crore (24 per cent), highlighting its central role in national infrastructure development. Ministry of Railways is implementing 255 projects (14 per cent), with a total revised project cost of Rs 8.69 lakh crore (21 per cent).

Ministry of Coal accounts for implementing 121 projects (7 per cent), with a total revised project cost of Rs 2.22 lakh crore (6 per cent).

The Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, Ministry of Power, Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs & Department of Water Resources, River Development & GR are implementing 105, 98, 50, and 40 projects, respectively, with associated revised costs of Rs 4.33 lakh crore, Rs 5.71 lakh crore, Rs 3.65 lakh crore, and Rs 2.04 lakh crore, respectively.

The remaining 156 projects (8 per cent), with a total revised cost of Rs 4.02 lakh crore (10 per cent), are distributed across various Ministries/ Departments including Higher Education, Civil Aviation, Steel, Telecommunications, Labour & Employment, Ports, Shipping & Waterways, Health & Family Welfare, Mines, DPIIT, and Sports.

Transport & Logistics remains the dominant sector, accounting for 55 per cent of total revised project cost (Rs

22.32 lakh crore) across 1,341 projects (73 per cent of the total Projects), underscoring the central role of Roads & Highways, Railways, Aviation, Urban Public Transport, Shipping, and Inland Waterways in economic integration and logistics efficiency.

The Energy sector follows with 26 per cent of aggregated revised cost (Rs 10.38 lakh crore) across 207 projects, reflecting sustained emphasis on Oil & Gas infrastructure, electricity generation, transmission and distribution networks, and energy storage systems.

Communication infrastructure, with a project cost of Rs 2.64 lakh crore (7 per cent) across 15 projects, represents targeted interventions aimed at strengthening digital connectivity. Water & Sanitation projects account for Rs 2.08 lakh crore (5 per cent) across 56 projects, highlighting continued focus on essential urban services.

Social & Commercial infrastructure, comprising 88 projects with a revised project cost of Rs 0.94 lakh crore (2 per cent), reflects selective investments in education, healthcare, real estate, and tourism, hospitality and wellness. Projects classified under 'Others', amounting to Rs 2.18 lakh crore (5 per cent) across 140 projects, indicate diversification across sectors such as coal, steel, metals & mining.

India's industrial production growth accelerates to 7.3% in June: Govt data

NEW DELHI: India's Index of Industrial Production (IIP) grew by 7.3 per cent YoY growth in June 2026, accelerating from a revised 5.0 per cent in May, supported by strong growth in manufacturing and electricity and gas supply sector.

As per a statement by the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation IIP growth rate for the month of June 2026 grew to 7.3 per cent from 5.1 per cent (Quick

Estimate) in May 2026. , This growth was mainly driven by a 7.8 per cent growth in the manufacturing sector and a 10.6 per cent surge in electricity and gas supply, it said.

Within the manufacturing sector, 19 of the 23 industry groups at the NIC 2-digit level recorded positive growth in June 2026 compared with June 2025, it said.

The leading contributors were manufacture of electrical

equipment, which grew 34.0 per cent, followed by motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers at 17.5 per cent, and food products at 10.8 per cent, as per the release.

Mining and quarrying, manufacturing, electricity and gas supply, and water supply, sewerage and waste management grew 1.0 per cent, 7.8 per cent, 10.6 per cent and 6.1 per cent, respectively, in June 2026, as per the release. ANI

PSBs' net profit hits ₹1.98 lakh cr in FY26, GNPA falls to 1.9%

NEW DELHI: Public Sector Banks (PSBs) witnessed a robust improvement in asset quality in FY26, with Gross non-performing assets (GNPAs) falling to a record-low 1.9 per cent and combined net profit hitting an all-time high of Rs 1.98 lakh crore, the Finance Ministry said.

As per a statement by the Finance Ministry, the aggregate business of Public Sector Banks crossed Rs 283 lakh crore in FY26, alongside robust credit growth, with MSME and retail

lending rising 19.6 per cent and 19.8 per cent, respectively.

"The financial health of Public Sector Banks (PSBs) have shown significant improvement with healthy balance sheets, historically high profits and multi-decadal low level of gross non-performing assets (GNPAs)," the Ministry said in the release.

As per the release, total deposits rose from Rs 107.2 lakh crore in FY22 to Rs 156.3 lakh crore in FY26 for PSBs. Likewise, total loans and

advances increased from Rs 74.3 lakh crore to Rs 127 lakh crore during the same period.

Net profit also surged from Rs 0.67 lakh crore in FY22 to Rs 1.98 lakh crore in FY26.

Meanwhile, Gross NPAs declined steadily from 7.3 per cent to 1.9 per cent.

Capital adequacy also strengthened, with the Capital to Risk-weighted Assets Ratio (CRAR) rising from 14.6 per cent to 16.6 per cent over the five-year period.

"PSBs have recorded sustained credit growth across different sectors of the economy," it said.

The release further highlighted, the government introduced the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS 5.0) in May 2026 to help businesses address short-term liquidity challenges arising from the West Asia crisis.

"The scheme provides guarantee coverage to Member Lending Institutions (MLIs) through National Credit Guar-

antee Trustee Company Limited (NCGTC) for the amount in default under the additional credit facility extended to the eligible borrowers," the release said.

The scheme offers 100 per cent guarantee coverage for MSMEs and 90 per cent for non-MSMEs and scheduled passenger airlines, with total credit support capped at Rs 2,55,000 crore, including Rs 5,000 crore specifically allocated to the scheduled passenger airline sector. ANI

Sport

Written in the scars

Beaten, abandoned, but unbroken: Sharmila's road to CWG gold

GLASGOW: When Sharmila Dhankar's husband abandoned her with their younger daughter barely 37 days old, it brought a painful but much-needed end to years of abuse that she had endured in the hope that things would one day get better.

At that time, the polio-afflicted and traumatised Sharmila did not know where life would take her. More than a decade later, the now 40-year-old stood on top of the Commonwealth Games podium with a gold medal around her neck after winning the women's F57 seated shot put title, a triumph that is as much about resilience as athletic ability.

"Everyone said it would stop, so I stayed," the vivacious para athlete told PTI as she recalled her time with her alcoholic first husband, who beat her for giving birth to two daughters. She said even their elder daughter was a victim of domestic violence.

Still, Sharmila stayed, hopeful of things improving at some point. They never did.

"My husband did not earn. He kept selling off everything. He used to hit me because I gave birth to two daughters. He also beat my elder daughter," she alleged.

The violence only intensified after the birth of their second child.



Sharmila Dhankar delivered a landmark performance by winning the women's shot put F57 title with a season-best effort of 9.81m

PTI

and child.

"After my second daughter was born, he would hit the elder one. When the younger one was just 37 days old, he threw us out of the house. Then my family came and got me divorced from him."

With nowhere else to go, Sharmila returned to her parents' home with her two daughters. For the next six years, she rebuilt her life, one day at a time.

Hardship, however, had fol-

Her triumph ended India's 20-year wait for a para-athletics medal at CWG

lowed her long before marriage.

She had contracted polio when she was just two years old, leaving her right leg permanently impaired.

"When I was two, I contracted polio. They gave me an injection for fever and

because of that my right leg was affected," she said unsure whether she was a victim of medical negligence.

She grew up in a family where every rupee mattered. Her mother was blind and had been married to a man 20 years older than her.

Despite the odds, her parents insisted that their children go to school.

"There were a lot of financial issues. But they made us study. From Class 1 to 10, I

never came second, not even in one test. I was always first," she said with a smile.

But education had to take a backseat due to resource constraints. "Because of money issues, I was married off (young)," she said.

But Her second marriage became the turning point that changed the course of her life. "My second husband introduced me to sports. Whatever he had, he invested in my sport." AGENCIES

Ajaya wins silver; new low for Nirupama

GLASGOW: Fast-rising Indian weightlifter Valuri Ajaya Babu produced a remarkable performance to win the silver medal in the men's 79kg category and continue the country's successful run in the sport. The 21-year-old from Andhra Pradesh's Vizianagaram district lifted a Games record 149kg in snatch and 181kg in clean and jerk for a total of 330kg to win the second prize, narrowly missing out on gold to Malaysia's Erry Hidayat Muhammad.

Nirupama Devi endured a heartbreaking outing in the women's 63kg weightlifting on Tuesday after failing all three of her clean and jerk attempts, resulting in a Did Not Finish.

AGENCIES

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: This is turning out to be a dream month for Sarvesh Kushare, as he soars to new highs in his illustrious career. On a chilly night at the Scotstoun Stadium here on Monday night, Sarvesh soared to a new high of 2.25 metres and sealed a silver medal.

Conditions were tricky, yet Sarvesh handled it with aplomb, even as Tejaswin Shankar had to drop out of the final with a major injury. Shankar did well to support Sarvesh through all his jumps, reflecting camaraderie. On June 27, Sarvesh Kushare had cleared 2.31 metres at home for a national record. It echoed the sentiment, he had arrived. In less than a fortnight, the bearded man was placed third in the Diamond League. And on Monday, a medal at the Commonwealth Games, which is defining for Indian track and field. The very fact two Indians were going into the final was good news. Tejaswin had a niggle and decided to not compete in pain. However, he will go whole hog in his new low – decathlon – later this week. Sarvesh was happy with his effort in Glasgow as he opened up with the media.



What is your first reaction on winning the medal? I am happy and my family is also very happy today as I won a silver medal. And I want to thank everyone, the Athletics Federation of India, OGQ, Army Sports Institute, and my coaches. My heartfelt thanks to all of them.

The way you competed with Tejaswin guiding you, how was the experience? Yes, Tejaswin supported me a lot. My body was cooling down a bit, and the weather conditions were a bit challenging. I was putting in 100% effort, but I missed 2.20m. But that's okay, the Asian Games are coming up next, so I will focus on that now.

Could you tell us a bit more about the weather conditions? The weather was getting a bit

cold, and with time passing in between attempts, the body was cooling down. But it's fine, we will perform better in future competitions.

Tejaswin pulled out of the event... Yes, he had an issue with his knee. Otherwise, he was in great shape, too, and could have done well.

There have been many phases in your journey. How do you look back at it? It is great. This is my first major medal, a silver at the Commonwealth Games. Otherwise, I participated in everything, the World Championships, Olympics. I was a mere participant and today my goal was to win a medal and give my personal best. Because of the weather, I couldn't deliver my best jump, but I brought home a medal, so I am happy.

Your personal best is 2.31m. If you maintain that, can we expect medals in the upcoming Asian Games and even the Olympics?

That's exactly what we are preparing for. Everyone is aiming for gold, and I am preparing for gold as well. It's just a matter of timing, if it's my day, I will win gold too. My coaches, RW Jadhav sir and Jithin Thomas, have worked extensively on my runway approach.

Tejaswin's selfless act, Shirse's grit steals show

GLASGOW: His own campaign derailed by a recurring knee problem, Tejaswin Shankar fought through tears and discomfort to be there for compatriot Sarvesh Kushare, offering him technical advice that proved crucial in securing his men's high jump silver in the Commonwealth Games here.

Tejaswin had claimed the high jump bronze in the 2022 Birmingham CWG, which

was a first ever for India in the sport. On Monday, the 27-year-old felt a sharp pain in his knee during his warm-up and could not continue in the competition after clearing his first attempt. Despite his own heartbreak, he stayed back at the venue and switched roles to help Kushare, who eventually fetched a silver medal, bettering Tejaswin's 2022 performance.

A visibly emotional Tejas-

win struggled to compose himself while speaking to reporters after the event. "I felt a shooting pain in my knee. It happened during my warm-up. It's nothing new; I have always had tendonitis in my knees," he said.

Shirse shows grit National record-holder Tejas Shirse's historic appearance in the men's 110m hurdles final ended in pain and heartbreak but demonstrated his grit

as he ran the race with a stress fracture in his left foot during the warm-up session to finish eighth and last in the event.

Instead of pulling out, Shirse ran with a heavily taped foot. He finished last in the eight-man field in 15.39 seconds. "I am the first Indian to qualify for the 110m hurdles final at the CWG, so I didn't want to let the whole nation down by pulling out." AGENCIES

ISSF WORLD CUP Sonam, Himanshu strike 10m air rifle bronze

HANGZHOU: Rifle shooters Sonam Uttam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon added another medal to India's campaign, clinching the bronze in the 10m air rifle mixed team event at the ISSF World Cup here on Tuesday.

The bronze medal took India's overall tally at the World Cup to four medals, including



1 gold, 1 silver, and 2 bronze. Both Indian teams deliv-

ered strong performances in the qualification round to advance to the final.

Sonam Uttam Maskar (317.2) and Himanshu Dhillon (317.4) combined for an aggregate qualification score of 634.6.

Meanwhile, the pair of Elavenil Valarivan (316.8) and Parth Rakesh Mane (317.4)

qualified right behind them with a total score of 634.2.

In the final, Sonam and Himanshu produced a composed performance to combine for 441.2 points (220.6 each), securing the bronze medal behind China 1 and China 2.

Elavenil (190.5) and Parth (188.3) finished fourth with a final score of 378.8. AGENCIES

उद्यान निदेशालय, झारखण्ड, राँची।
कृषि भवन, कोक रोड, राँची-834008
(कृषि प्रशिक्षण एवं सहायता विभाग)

Email ID-ddhranchi@rediffmail.com

E-Tender/Horti/02/2026-27

S.No.	Tender No.	Horti/02/26-27
1	Name of Work	Supply & Installation Of Processing Unit/Components Under Processing -cum-value addition in Horticulture - cum-non timber forest produce Of Directorate Of Horticulture, Jharkhand, for a period of one year
2	Period	The scheme pertains to the Financial Year 2025 –26. The agency for implementation of the scheme shall be selected for Financial Year 2025 –27.
3	Tender Form Cost	Not applicable as per Jharkhand Procurement of Goods and Services Manual 2024
4	Total Project Cost	Rs. 450.00 Lakhs (Item wise tentative cost has been attached as Annexure VIII A to VIII H of BID Paper)
5	EMD Amount	02% of BID Value i.e; 9 lakhs (to be paid online only)
6	Date of Publication of Tender on website	29-07-2026
7	Document Download Period	29-07-2026 from 10:00 AM to 18-08-2026, 10:00 AM
8	Online Bid Submission Period	29-07-2026 from 10:00 AM to 18-08-2026, 12:00 PM
9	EMD submission date	The Tender documents along with EMD as mentioned in the document should be submitted online only till date 18-08-2026, 12:00 PM
10	Date and Place of Pre Bid Meeting	03-08-2026 at 01:00 PM Directorate of Horticulture, 3 rd Floor, KrishiBhawan, Kanke Road, Ranchi-834008
11	Date and Place of Technical Bid Opening	18-08-2026 at 01:00 PM Directorate of Horticulture, 3 rd Floor, KrishiBhawan, Kanke Road, Ranchi-834008
12	Date and Place of Financial Bid Opening	21-08-2026 at 02:00 PM Directorate of Horticulture, 3 rd Floor, KrishiBhawan, Kanke Road, Ranchi-834008
13	Name and Address of the Tender inviting Authority	Shri Praveen Kerketta Director Horticulture, Jharkhand, Ranchi
14	Contact No. and email id of e-procurement officer	7903964045, ddhranchi@rediffmail.com

नोट : <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> के माध्यम से प्राप्त Online निविदा पर ही विचार किया जायेगा। **₹0/-**
PR 385991 Agriculture(26-27)D **निदेशक उद्यान, झारखण्ड, राँची।**

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, राँची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना

नाम-पिकी देवी, उम्र-28 वर्ष, (साथ में दो बच्चे), उँचाई-5 फिट, रंग-गोरा,पहनावा-नीला रंग की सूट पहनी हुई है

उपरोक्त लापता महिला पिकी देवी, उम्र-28 वर्ष, (साथ में दो बच्चे) पति-कौशल कुमार, सा0-नाथीगाँव, थाना-खेलगाँव, जिला-राँची जो दिनांक-18.07.2026 को अपने घर से गैर बताए कहीं चली गई जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई है। जिसके संबंध में खेलगाँव थाना सनहा स0-18 / 2026, दिनांक-20.07.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता महिला कहीं मिलती / दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

Email ID(mrc-dcb@jhpolic.e.gov.in)

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पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, सादर, राँची।
आवेदक कौशल कुमार।
वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
राँची

PR 386087 (Police)26-27*D

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.: JHS-N-W-53-26 Date: 27.07.2026

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-53-26

Description of work: Provision of S&T work in connection with TRR (20.201 Tkm) in BINA-DHO Section along with Renewal of Glued Joints - 341 Nos. in BINA- VGLJ, VGLJ-PRN & JHS-MKP Section of Jhansi division.

Approx Cost: Rs. 10898812.06 | **Earnest Money:** Rs. 218000.00

Cost of Tender Form: Nil | **Opening of tender:** 21.08.2026, Time 15:00

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 12 Months

* Tender on line can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs. on 21.08.2026.
* For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 1727/26 (PH)

North central railways **@CPRONCR** **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. PU-TDL-W-05-2026 Dated: 27.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

Dy. CSTE/CTC/NCRPU/Tundla, N. C. Railway, for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E- Tendering) for the following work.

SN.: 01 | E-Tender Notice No.: PU-TDL-W-05-2026 | Cost of Tender form:Nil

Description of work: Construction of S&T service buildings (LSC) in BFP- KXM and AGC- RKM sections in connection with the work of Relay Based to Electronic Interlocking (EI) based Automatic Signalling works in BFP-KXM and AGC-RKM section of Agra Division of North Central Railway.

Approx Cost (₹): ₹ 2,04,83,852.46/- (₹ Two Crore Four Lakh Eighty Three Thousand Eight Hundred Fifty Two and Forty Six Paise Only)

Bid Security(₹): ₹ 4,09,700/- (₹ Four Lakh Nine Thousand Seven Hundred Only)

Date of closing: 19.08.2026 | **Completion of period:** 09 Months

Note - (1) The complete information along with Tender document of above E-Works Tender will be available on Website on www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 Hrs. on the due date of Tender opening. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose Venders are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital signature certificate issued by CCA under IT Act 2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by Tenderer shall be straight way ignored & shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed by the Tenderer on its body. (5) For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1723/26(AK)

North central railways **@CPRONCR** **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely **Akshay @ Body S/o** Auda @ Suresh R/o H. No.- M -501, Raghubir Nagar, New Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 80105266/24 U/s 303(2)/3(5) BNS PS: Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akshay @ Body** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akshay @ Body** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Akshay @ Body** accused of **E-FIR No. 80105266/24 U/s 303(2)/3(5) BNS PS: Janakpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
JMFC-11 Room No. 05
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/10010/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

AMM/EMU/GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India Invites E-Tender against Tender No. 46265210 the details are as under:

Name of Work	Approx. cost of work	Quantity	01 Nos
Diesel generating set 750 KVA with AMF panel confirming to COF/MOW Specification NO.CO/MOW/IR/D.G Set with AMF/2015 Rev-IV or Latest, including PMC 02 Years + CAMC 05 years after warranty.	₹9599181.13/-		

Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender 25.08.2026 (11:00 hrs.)
Date of Time of Opening of tender document 25.08.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen www.ireps.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderers must be registered on the Indian Railways E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in. (ii) Please refer to the tender document for all terms and conditions. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable.
NIT No.: 46265210 **Date: 27.07.2026**

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE **2602/2026**

UJVNL LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 625 **Time Extension Tender Notice** Date: 28/07/2026

Due to unavoidable reason, the dates of Tender NIT No.: 06/EE(MPH)/2026-27 and 07/EE(MPH)/2026-27 invited by the office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Mohammadpur Power House, Gurukul Narsan, Haridwar are hereby extended:-

Date of availability of bid document on website: 28-07-2026
Last date for submission of Tender: 03.08.2026 up to 12:00 Hrs
Date of opening of tender: 04.08.2026 at 11:00 Hrs

All other terms and conditions of tender shall remain unchanged. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com".

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Sheikh Riyajuddin @ Akbar S/o Sheikh Gulam Rasool, R/o Jhuggi No. C-263, Near Kushal Cinema, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 111/2021, U/s 454/380/34 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Sheikh Riyajuddin @ Akbar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Sheikh Riyajuddin @ Akbar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Sheikh Riyajuddin @ Akbar** of case **FIR No. 111/2021, U/s 454/380/34 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **01.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 32
DP/10147/N/2026
(Court Matter) **Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

Section 82 (ii) Cr.Pc.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **1. Sahil s/o Amrit R/o Cycle Market, Opp. Lal Quila, Delhi also at-Vill. Toli, Distt-Bajura, Nepal. 2. Kamal Kumar s/o Prem Kumar R/o B-24,Shalimar Garden, Ghaziabad, UP** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No.596/2021 u/s 380/411/34 IPC** has been registered at **P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **1.Sahil 2.Kamal Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **1. Sahil 2. Kamal Kumar** has absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **1. Sahil 2. Kamal Kumar** of under **FIR. No. 596/2021 u/s 380/411/34 IPC** registered at: **P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.09.2026**.

By Order
Mokha Bains
JMFC-II, West, Room No.31,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10296/WD/2026
(court notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Imran S/o: Nawab R/o: B-215, Janta Colony, Welcome, Seelampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 58/2021, U/S: 379/411/34 IPC, PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Imran**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Imran**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Imran of FIR No. 58/2021, U/S: 379/411/34 IPC, PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
Central, Room No. 138 Central District
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9899/N/2026
(Court Matter)

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Material Management Department

(e' Tender Notice for the supply of Stores, No.EPS/21/2026)

PCMM/WCR on behalf of the President of India invites the following advertised tenders through E procurement System. No manual/postal offers shall be entertained. Tenders can be accessed under the link www.ireps.gov.in for details and for submission of Tender.

Sr No.	Tender No.	Short Description	Tendered Due Date
1	81265323	Manufacture and supply of Metal Liner as per drawing no. RDSOT-8995.	146714 Nos. 03/08/2026
2	38261979	High capacity Draft Gear complete	943 Nos. 17/08/2026
3	38262406	INNER SPRING FOR CASNUB 22HS. BOGIE TO	14659 Nos. 17/08/2026
4	30261656	DRAFT YOKE (FABRICATED DESIGN) AS PER ICF DRG. No. T-2-1-012, ALT. -q/3: MATERIAL CONFIRMING TO RDSO SPEC. NO. C-9509, REV-02	566 Nos. 25/08/2026
5	65255011	Supply, Installation and Commissioning of 15 TON Capacity EOT CRANE as per attached documents	2 Nos. 27/08/2026
6	61261119	T-Max Inserts Sandvik Part No. 175 32 301940 25 M 3015, WIDIA Part No. LNUX	9972 Nos. 27/08/2026
7	65265007	Supply, installation and Commissioning of Flat Work Ironer, Roller Size 800 x 3000 mm	2 Nos. 01/09/2026
8	38265015	End Stanchion for BOXNHL	1600 Nos. 02/09/2026
9	30261502	Procurement of Improved High Tensile tight lock Centre buffer coupler with AAR -H	387 Set 07/09/2026
10	20264515	Brake Shoe Complete Nominal	24118 Nos. 07/09/2026
11	65265006	Supply, Installation & Commissioning of electrically operated Synchronised screw lifting jacks	2 Set 08/09/2026
12	30261642	GANGWAY BRIDGE MOUNTING ASSEMBLY	603 Nos. 09/09/2026

"For tenders with estimated value below Rs. 50 lakh, interested firms are advised to Visit www.ireps.gov.in" **Sd/-**

For Principal Material Manager, West Central Railway, Jabalpur

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

BSNL

भारत संचार निगम लिमिटेड

BSNL CO, NEW DELHI

No. BSNLCO-11/12(11)/4/2026-RECTT-CO

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) invites applications from eligible candidates for the post of Company Secretary under the Direct Recruitment Scheme.

Interested candidates are advised to visit www.bsnl.co.in regularly for the detailed notification and subsequent updates.

BSNL CO, NEW DELHI

CBC 06204/12/0009/2627

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Satish @ TC, S/o: Ram Parvesh Prasad, R/o: Gali No. 6, Kamlesh Ka Makan, Village Salapur Khara, Kapashera, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 00080/2023, U/s 379/411 IPC, P.S.: Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Satish @ TC** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Satish @ TC** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Satish @ TC** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 00080/2023, U/s 379/411 IPC, P.S.: Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Vijayshree Rathore
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 13, Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/10236/SW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu Kumar, S/o Lt. Birbal Kumar, R/o 26/6, Jacobpura, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **Ct Case No. 3717/2019, P.S. Gazipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sonu Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sonu Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonu Kumar** accused of **Ct Case No. 3717/2019, P.S. Gazipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.09.2026**.

By Order - **Sh. Sachin**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, East District
DP/10271/ED/2026 **Room No. 16, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Atul Kumar R/o H. No. -9, Sec-21, Pocket 12, Rohini, Delhi** also at C/o I.T.V. Network, B-4, Sec 3, Noida 201301 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 8306/17 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Atul Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Atul Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Atul Kumar in CC No. 8306/17 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.09.2026 at 10:00am**.

By order
Sh. Arjun Kirar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 NI ACT
Central, CBA-1, Room No.2
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10278/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Akhtar S/o Usman Shekh R/o B-145, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 725/2022 U/S 356/379/511/34 IPC at P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Akhtar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Akhtar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Akhtar** accused of **FIR No. 725/2022 U/S 356/379/511/34 IPC at P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **07.09.2026**.

By Order: **Ms. Bharti Beniwal,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North),
Court No. 114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/10331/ON/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Branch Office : ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

Notice under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 is being issued by ICICI Bank Ltd. (on the underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Devan Housing Finance Ltd.) in relation to the enforcement of security concerning a Housing Loan Facility granted pursuant to a Loan agreement entered into between DHFL and the following borrower(s) who has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan Facility(ies) obtained by them from the secured creditor. The Loans have been classified as Non-Performing Assets (NPA). A notice was issued to them at their last known addresses; however, it has returned un-served and hence, they are hereby notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ & Address (DHFL, Old LAN & ICICI New LAN)	Property Address of Secured Asset / Asset to be Enforced	Date of Notice Sent / Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Aman Kathuria/ Amrita/ QZGUR00005000123/ House No.453, Dda Flats, RGB-Block, Raghubir Nagar, Delhi New Delhi- 110027	Flat No.405, Tower-8, Fourth Floor, Mvn Athens Sohna, Situated At Sector-5, Gurgaon, Haryana 122102	04/07/2026 Rs. 12,01,471/-	24-Jun-2026
2.	Anand Parkash/ Sushila Devi/ QZFD800005000963/ C/7/8, Duggal Colony Khanpur Delhi- 110062	Property Unit No C-2, 2th Floor (Rear Right Hand Side), Kharsa No. 25/25/2, Khewat No- 295, Situated At Village Devli Tehsil Hauz Khos, Now Tehsil Saket (M.B. Road) New Delhi 110080.	04/07/2026 Rs. 8,36,114/-	11-May-2026

The steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower(s) and/or the guarantor(s) of the Loan (as applicable) is/are advised to make the payments of the outstanding within the period of 60 days from the date of the publication of this Notice else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: July 29, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ncr

Authorised Officer
Team ICICI Bank

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Raja @Monu S/o Vijay R/o H. No. H-4/669 Jhuggi No. 30, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 101/20 U/s 25 ARMS ACT, PS Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Raja @Monu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raja @Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Raja @Monu** in **FIR No. 101/20 U/s 25 ARMS ACT, PS Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.09.2026**.

By order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10201/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mohd. Salman S/o Mohd Guddu R/o G-95, Ghazipur Village, Gopal Gali, Patparganj Industrial Area, East Delhi, Also at: G-78, Ghazipur Village, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 589/2023, U/S 380/411/34 IPC, PS Patparganj Industrial Area, East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Salman** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Salman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Mohd. Salman** the said accused of **FIR No. 589/2023, U/S 380/411/34 IPC, PS Patparganj Industrial Area, East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
East Distt., Room No.-03, 2nd Floor,
Karkardooms Courts, Delhi

DP/10224/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. : JHS-N-W-68-26 Date : 25.07.2026

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No. : JHS-N-W-68-26	Approx Cost : Rs. 65416668.84
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Description of work : Comprehensive annual maintenance contract of Multi section Digital Axle counter for Siemens make Detection Points (DP) in the BINA-DHO section of Jhansi division for a period of three years.

Earnest Money : Rs. 1308300/-	Cost of Tender Form : Nil.
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Opening of tender : 21.08.2026 Time : 15:00

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 36 Months

* Tender on line can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 21.08.2026 * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 1717/26 (C)

North central railways **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in** **@CPRONC**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sonia W/o Bunty, R/o H. No. A-130, Gali No. 13, M.S.C. Mohalla, Yogmaya, Pharganj Central Delhi-55, India** (and All Other Known Addresses), has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 183/2020 U/s 376D/376/328/506/34/109/344/509/323/384/366 IPC PS: Paschim Vihar East Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sonia** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sonia** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonia** accused of **FIR No. 183/2020 U/s 376D/376/328/506/34/109/344/509/323/384/366 IPC** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rajinder Singh
Ld. ASJ (SC-RC)-02, West District
DP/10350/OD/2026
(Court Matter) **Room No. 120, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that that accused person(s) **Vivek @ Vicky @ Vikas @ Murgi S/o Puran Singh R/o RZ-H/89, Nihal Vihar, Delhi**, has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 531/2023, U/s 392/411/34 IPC, PS Ranahola, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Vivek @ Vicky @ Vikas @ Murgi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Vivek @ Vicky @ Vikas @ Murgi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Vivek @ Vicky @ Vikas @ Murgi** of case **FIR No. 531/2023, U/s 392/411/34 IPC, PS Ranahola, Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **09.12.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
Metropolitan Magistrate-08
(West), Room No. 30
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9436/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

e-tender Notice No. 30 of 2026-27 (Open) - Engg/DDU

On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings:-

A GEN Z PROTEST, SONGS ACROSS GENERATIONS



The Gen Z-led protest found its rhythm in Faiz Ahmad Faiz, AR Rahman and Michael Jackson

ANINDITA ACHARYA

The Gen Z-led NEET paper leak protests are over. Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has resigned. From viral memes and 'pookie' humour to playlists, the protest seemed to have the vibe of a college fest. But was Gen Z the only generation powering the protest?

If Gen Z was sweating it out on the streets of Jantar Mantar in New Delhi and later in other parts of the country, braving 'lathi' charges and tear gas, the millennials and even the boomers quietly amplified the movement through music.

Gen Z, after all, is the same generation that made spy reels from 'Dhurandhar', danced to 'Jamal Kudu' from 'Animal' and filled social media with bizarre reactions inside 'Saiyaara' screenings. So, when boomers and millennials dismissed them as 'delulu with no solulu', Gen Z proved them wrong. They may have been the biggest repeat audience for 'Dhurandhar' (one of India's highest-grossing films last year) and its

songs may still dominate their playlists, but when it came to the protest ground and 'Instagram' reels, they reached for songs that were released two decades ago. Would it be incorrect to say that the soundtrack of the Gen Z protest had songs that belonged largely to the millennial and boomer eras?

Take 'Hum Dekhenge'. Written by Pakistani poet Faiz Ahmad Faiz in 1979 and immortalised by Iqbal Bano's haunting rendition, it became one of the defining protest anthems of the NEET paper leak movement.

Interestingly, many of the songs that echoed through the demonstrations came from films starring Aamir Khan and Shah Rukh Khan. Neither Bollywood superstar publicly backed the students. Aamir even distanced himself from the protests, clarifying that his '3 Idiots' (2009) character was not inspired by Sonam Wangchuk. Yet, songs from '3 Idiots' and 'Rang De Basanti' became the unmistakable soundtrack of the movement.

'3 Idiots', with its critique of India's education system, contributed 'Give Me Some Sunshine', a song released 17 years ago, when many of today's protesters were still children. It found fresh life in countless protest reels.

But it was Aamir Khan's 'Rang De Basanti'

The faces leading the protest were Gen Z, but the playlist united generations

(2006), with AR Rahman's iconic soundtrack, that became the unofficial album of the protests. Released two decades ago, before many of these Gen Z students were even born, Rakeysh Omprakash Mehra's film showed a group of university students whose journey sparked conversations on patriotism and dissent. Scenes from the film, along with songs like 'Khoon Chala' and the high-energy title track 'Rang De Basanti', flooded social media timelines and protest videos.

Rahman's 'Sadda Haq' from Ranbir Kapoor's 'Rockstar' (2011) was another recurring anthem in the movement. Neither Ranbir nor Ranveer Singh commented

on the student movement that eventually led to the Union Education Minister's resignation. But their songs certainly showed up. 'Azaadi' from 'Gully Boy' (Ranveer Singh and Alia Bhatt), performed by DIVINE and Dub Sharma, became another favourite among the young protesters.

Rahman's Academy Award-winning 'Jai Ho' from 'Slumdog Millionaire' (2008) found resonance too, as did his stirring rendition of 'Vande Mataram'.

'Chak De! India', composed by Salim Sulaiman and sung by Sukhwinder Singh, may have been written as a sports anthem, but it found a second life on the protest grounds. Shah Rukh Khan returned to India only after the demonstrations had ended and did not comment on the students' protests. Yet, his 'Swades' (2004) classic 'Yeh Jo Des Hai Tera', another Rahman gem, became another emotional favourite in protest reels.

The playlist didn't stop there. 'Vartap', 'Chale Chalo' from 'Lagaan', Rabindra Sangeet's 'Ekla Cholo Re', Amit Trivedi's 'Azaadiyan' from 'Udaan' and the revolutionary anthem 'Sarfaroshi Ki Tamanna' all became musical companions of the protest. And then there were the global entries. Michael Jackson, technically a Baby Boomer born in 1958, moonwalked

SING ALONG

- Hum Dekhenge
- Give Me Some Sunshine
- Khoon Chala
- Rang De Basanti
- Sadda Haq
- Yeh Jo Des Hai Tera
- Chale Chalo
- They Don't Care About Us
- Where Is the Love?
- No More Dream

into the protests through 'They Don't Care About Us', which featured prominently in Gen Z reels. The Black Eyed Peas' 2003 hit 'Where Is the Love?' also resurfaced as students demanded accountability.

And because no Gen Z affair feels complete without BTS, the K-pop superstars made their presence felt too. From 'No More Dream' and 'N.O.' to 'Not Today', BTS tracks became part of reels documenting the students' fight against the education scam.

The faces leading the movement may have belonged to Gen Z, but if there was one thing that united generations, it was the playlist.

Rekha, Pankaj Tripathi to be honoured at IFFM 2026

'Umrao Jaan has never left me,' says the veteran actress

Veteran Hindi cinema star Rekha will attend the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne as guest of honour, where she will be presented with the prestigious excellence in cinema award, while actor Pankaj Tripathi will be honoured with the Artist of Distinction award.

The festival will screen 'Umrao Jaan' to celebrate Rekha's unparalleled body of work and extraordinary contribution to Indian cinema that spans across movies such as 'Silsila', 'Khoobsurat', 'Tjaazat', 'Ghar', 'Khoon Bhari Maang', 'Khiladiyon Ka Khiladi' and 'Koi... Mil Gaya'. Directed by Muzaffar Ali, 'Umrao Jaan' is one of the most defining films in Rekha's career and celebrated 45 years of its release this year.

"Umrao Jaan' has never left me. She lives in my memories, in my silences and in the hearts of those who have embraced her with a lot of love over the years. To revisit that journey and see the film being celebrated on a global stage is both humbling and moving. Cinema has been my life's greatest blessing and to be honoured with the Excellence in Cinema Award at IFFM 2026 is special. I accept this honour with immense gratitude, not only as a recognition of my own journey, but also as a tribute to the filmmakers, writers, musicians and countless collaborators who have enriched my life and shaped my work, she said.

The actress will also hoist the Indian flag in Melbourne on August 15 alongside members of the Indian diaspora,



While she'll be presented with the prestigious excellence in cinema award, Tripathi will be honoured with the Artist of Distinction award

Australian dignitaries, filmmakers, artists and cinema lovers.

Meanwhile, the honour to Pankaj Tripathi will be presented to celebrate the actor's exceptional contribution to Indian cinema and his remarkable journey as one of the country's most respected performers. This will also be the first time the National Award-winning actor will attend the festival and receive the honour in Melbourne, Australia, according to a press release.



Tripathi, known for his roles in projects such as 'Gangs of Wasseypur', 'Newton', 'Stree' and others, said it is 'truly special and incredibly meaningful' to receive the award.

"To be soon receiving the 'Artist of Distinction' honour at the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne is deeply humbling. As an actor, I have always believed that stories have the extraordinary power to transcend boundaries, connect hearts and bring people closer, irrespective of language or geography. To have my journey be recognised on an international platform like IFFM... Every milestone in my career has been possible because of the trust and collaboration of filmmakers, writers, directors, fellow actors, technicians and above all, the audiences who have embraced my work with so much love. This recognition belongs as much to them as it does to me," he said. PTI



'SPIDER-MAN: BRAND NEW DAY' FIRST REACTIONS

HIGH PRAISE FOR TOM HOLLAND; SADIE SINK'S ROLE PAYS OFF

Ahead of its July 31 theatrical release, the makers organised a world premiere of the highly anticipated film in Los Angeles on July 27

With the worldwide release of director Destin Daniel Cretton's Spider-Man: Brand New Day right around the corner, fans of the 'Marvel Cinematic Universe' (MCU) are ecstatic and ready to welcome their beloved superhero. Meanwhile, ahead of its July 31 theatrical release, the makers organised a world premiere of the highly anticipated film in Los Angeles on July 27 and social media is now flooded with reactions from those who attended.

While some have heaped praise on the superhero film, a few expressed mixed feelings. However, no reviews thus far have outright bashed the movie, suggesting it won't disappoint fans entirely.

Mentioning that Destin Daniel Cretton injects a ferocious energy into Spider-Man's latest adventure, an 'X' user named Erik Davis wrote that the film 'delivers all the thrills you'd expect from a Tom Holland Spider-Man movie while feeling deeper, more thoughtful and more mature than the previous trilogy.'

"That maturity extends beyond the story to the action, with Cretton crafting some of my favourite Spider-Man fight sequences of the Holland era. Part detective story, part psychological thriller, part buddy comedy (the Spider-Man/Punisher banter is so much fun),



it stretches in exciting new directions before becoming a genuine love letter to the fans. When you see it, you'll get it. And yes, the Sadie Sink mystery absolutely pays off. She's perfect," he added.

Calling 'Brand New Day' his 'new favourite Spider-Man movie', one Matt Nando Kelly noted, "It's absolutely incredible. Looks gorgeous. Writing is sharp. Performances are excellent. I was smiling the entire time. Even teared up. I am SHOCKED at how good this is."

Opining that 'Brand New Day' may be 'the most Marvel-Marvel movie I've ever marvelled', Emmy-winning TV host Brandon Pope wrote, "Destin Daniel Cretton honours beloved Spider-

While some have heaped praise on the superhero film, a few expressed mixed feelings. However, no reviews thus far have outright bashed the movie, suggesting it won't disappoint fans entirely

Man media - especially Raimi - to create something soulful + thrilling. Hulk, Punisher deliver. Big reveal lives up. The best of the Tom Holland Spidey series."

He added, "Brand New Day" is just the jolt the MCU needed heading into 'Doomsday'. Give Destin Daniel Cretton the keys to whatever 'Marvel' film he wants. He brings a distinct style to Spidey that really adds to the world and leans into the comic book wonder."

While one person called the movie a 'triumph from Destin Daniel Cretton', another one shared that it offers a 'fantastic experience'. A third netizen noted that the film features "Tom Holland's best performance in a film this summer and it also features a fantastic Jon Bernthal."

However, not all reactions are positive. Calling Brand New Day 'a mixed



bag', an 'X' account named "The Holo-Files" wrote, "It evokes the very best and the very worst of Sam Raimi's 'Spider-Man' trilogy. The first 20 minutes are quintessential comic book Spidey and do for Spider-Man what the first 20 minutes of Matt Reeves' 'The Batman' did for Batman. The film explores loneliness among young adults with delicacy and emotion and Tom Holland delivers yet another amazing performance as Peter Parker."

It added, "Unfortunately, the film mirrors 'Spider-Man 3' in being overstuffed with far too many elements and having stop-start pacing. The humour doesn't land, in part due to how disappointingly relegated to the background Ned is. Despite a strong turn from Sadie Sink, the third act is hijacked by her character and culminates in a painfully flat climax. Destin Daniel Cretton makes easily the most visually appealing MCU Spidey movie to date and brings incredible style and intimacy to the filmmaking. There's a lot to love and a lot to be frustrated by with 'Brand New Day.' AGENCIES